MODULE 09 · AMBITIOUS ENTREPRENEURSHIP

From Prototype to Product

How do you turn users into revenue?

COURSE PATH



COURSE MATERIAL · SCAN NOW

All slides live on GitHub

The newest version, free, no account needed

github.com/BaNburger/
AmbitiousEntrepreneurship

1. **Open the link**
   github.com/BaNburger/AmbitiousEntrepreneurship
2. **Go to modules**
   then 09-prototype-to-product
3. **Click the lecture PDF**
   M09_Lecture_Prototype-to-Product.pdf, download top right

Public course repository of Ambitious Entrepreneurship. The QR code opens github.com/BaNburger/AmbitiousEntrepreneurship.

WHERE WE ARE · THE COURSE

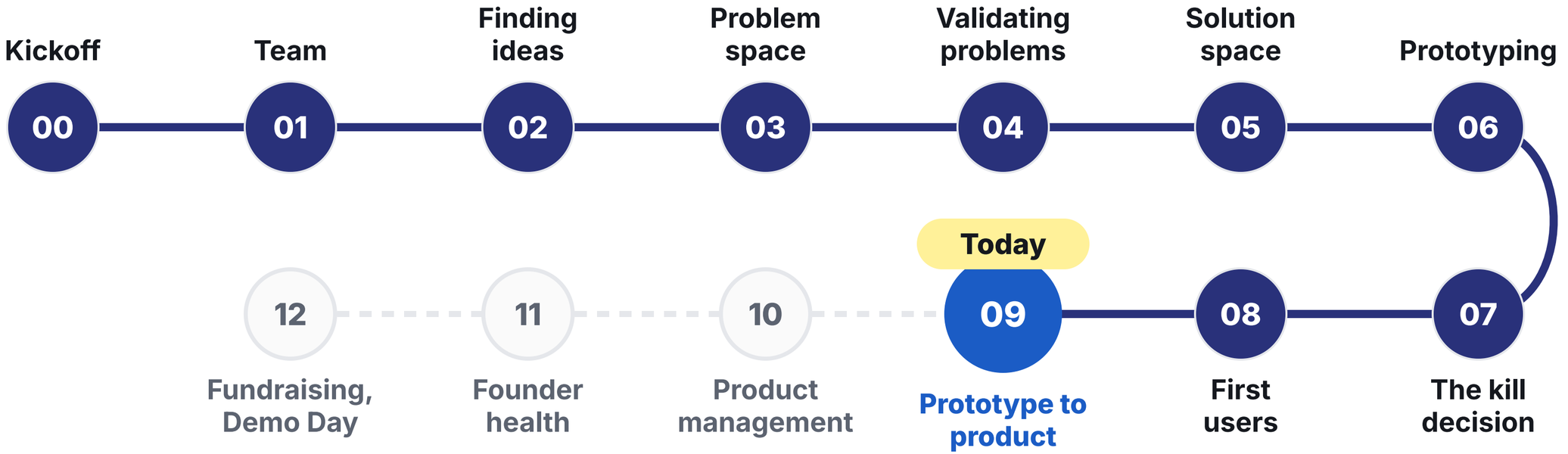
From first payment to a product

Thirteen sessions from first idea to first revenue. What teams have by now:

A working slice people use
Prototyping (M06)

A verdict: go, pivot or kill
The kill decision (M07)

First paying users
First users (M08)



CHECK-IN · SHOW OF HANDS

Who got paid by a stranger since last time?

Paying users from outside your social graph

0	1	2	3+
still asking	the floor	paying users	the full bar

2:00

How much did they pay?

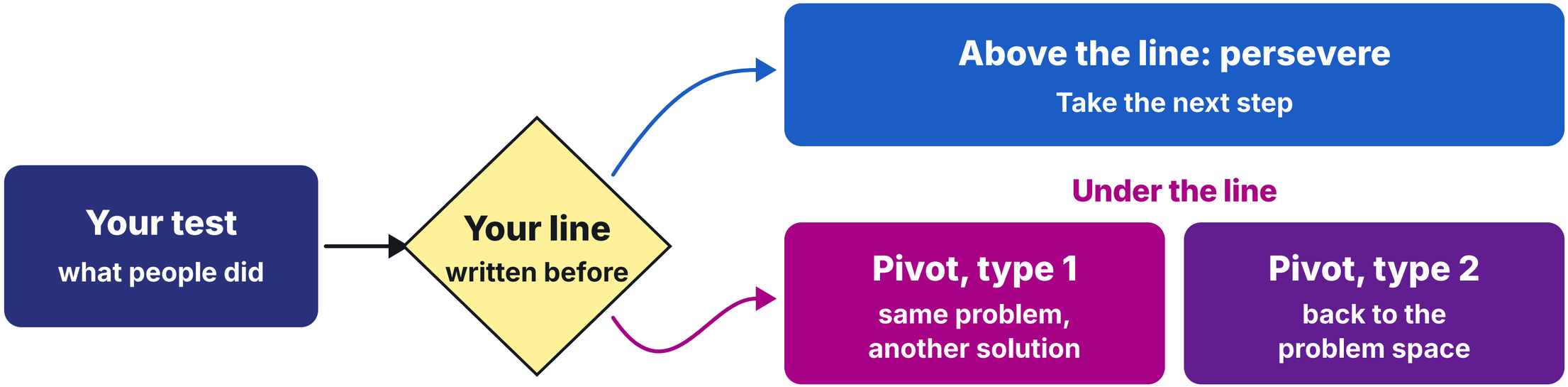
How did you close it?

What did they ask for right after?

PIVOT OR PERSEVERE

Under your line? That is a decision, not a failure

Your last test: did named people from your segment pay?



Both are progress. The only miss: no line, so no decision

FRAMEWORK Pivot or persevere after Ries, E. (2011), The Lean Startup. Pivot types as in the course Glossary.

ACCOUNTABILITY

Report what you did, not what you planned



User interactions?

What did you learn?



New revenue?

Why did they pay?



Shipped?

Why does it matter?

🦄 **Report target vs. actual in small groups**

CHAPTER 1 OF 9

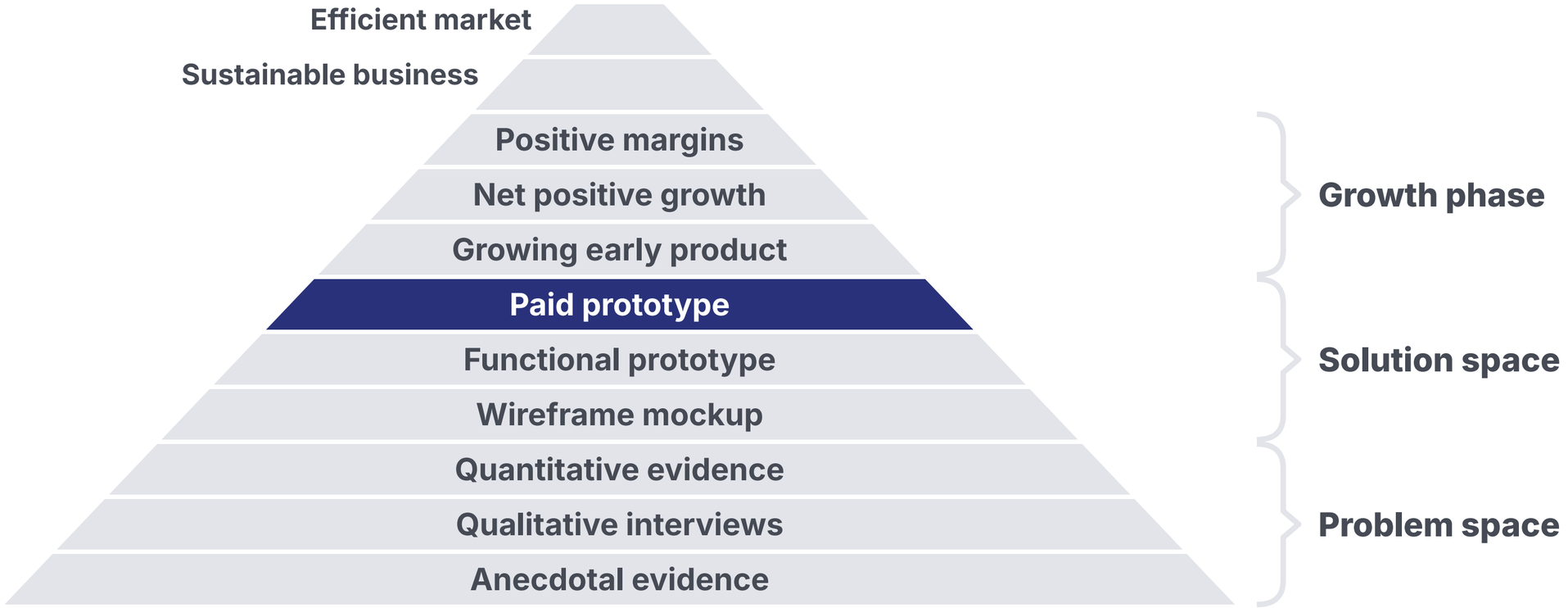
Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

Three pictures from earlier sessions that today builds on, then the module's rule.

01 **Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship**
02 Your presentations
03 **Price it: a price from value, tested**
04 **Sell it: the ask inside the product**
05 **Run it: checkout, webhook and deploy**
06 **Protect it: keep the money legal**
07 Wrap-up and check-out
08 Workshop: Revenue Sprint
09 Case discussion

PREVIOUSLY · FIRST USERS (M08)

A wallet opened. Rung six



PREVIOUSLY · FIRST USERS (M08)

You were their concierge. Now the product is

IMPRESSIONS

- Always be posting
- Improve your targeting
- Improve your relevance

Tool
Posting & outreach

CLICKS

- Farm your friends & family
- Guide through keynotes & presentations

Tool
Keep the flywheel going

SIGN-UPS

- Demos, interviews, ...
- Personal interaction

Tool
Interviewing techniques

CUSTOMERS

- Show attention
- Manage your funnel
- Be their concierge

Tool
Managing your funnel

PREVIOUSLY · FIRST USERS (M08)

Every hour answers one of two questions

	Founder 1	Founder 2	Founder 3
9:00	Co-founder alignment	Co-founder alignment	Co-founder alignment
10:00	Customer interview	Create content	Customer interview
13:00	Schedule new interviews	Engage with community	Build product
15:00	Customer interview	Update landing page	Build product
16:00	Customer interview	Customer interview	Build product (ship)
17:00	Customer interview	Customer interview	Document learnings
19:00	Joint learnings	Joint learnings	Joint learnings
20:00	Administrative work	Administrative work	Administrative work

13:00 to 16:00. Does this help you learn to make **revenue**?

20:00. Does it keep you **out of jail**?

AND FOR RESEARCHERS & ENGINEERS

Never build anything without customer need!

Never

Anytime you do so, it is your hobby, not your job.

build

Create something that someone can interact with.

anything

A thing you spend time on.

customer

A person who pays money for your service or product.

need

Something that creates a little bit more money.

CHAPTER 2 OF 9

Your presentations

Your first customers, their objections and your funnel, three minutes per team.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 **Your presentations**

03 **Price it: a price from value, tested**

04 **Sell it: the ask inside the product**

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YOUR PRESENTATIONS · MAKE IT CREDIBLE

Show us where you're at in 3 minutes or less!

3:00

Facts

Statistics or research

The offer and price asked, who paid, your channel and its number

12 Numbers

Usage or surveys

Funnel per channel, paying users against the bar (1 floor, 3 full), revenue against the kill line

Quotes

Interviews

Two objections, word for word, with roles

Images

Screenshots or users

Dashboard or paid invoice, no customer data

What did you do? | **What did you learn?** | **How can we help?**

LET'S JUMP IN!

Keep learning about the problem until customers will

Pay you



Photo: geralt on Pixabay.

INPUT 1 OF 4 · CHAPTER 3 OF 9

Price it: a price from value, tested

Set the price from the value you create, then test it like any other guess.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 **Price it: a price from value, tested**

04 **Sell it: the ask inside the product**

05 **Run it: checkout, webhook and deploy**

06 **Protect it: keep the money legal**

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INPUT 1 OF 4 · PRICE IT · THREE QUESTIONS

What should it cost?

1

How do you set the price?

2

What do they pay for?

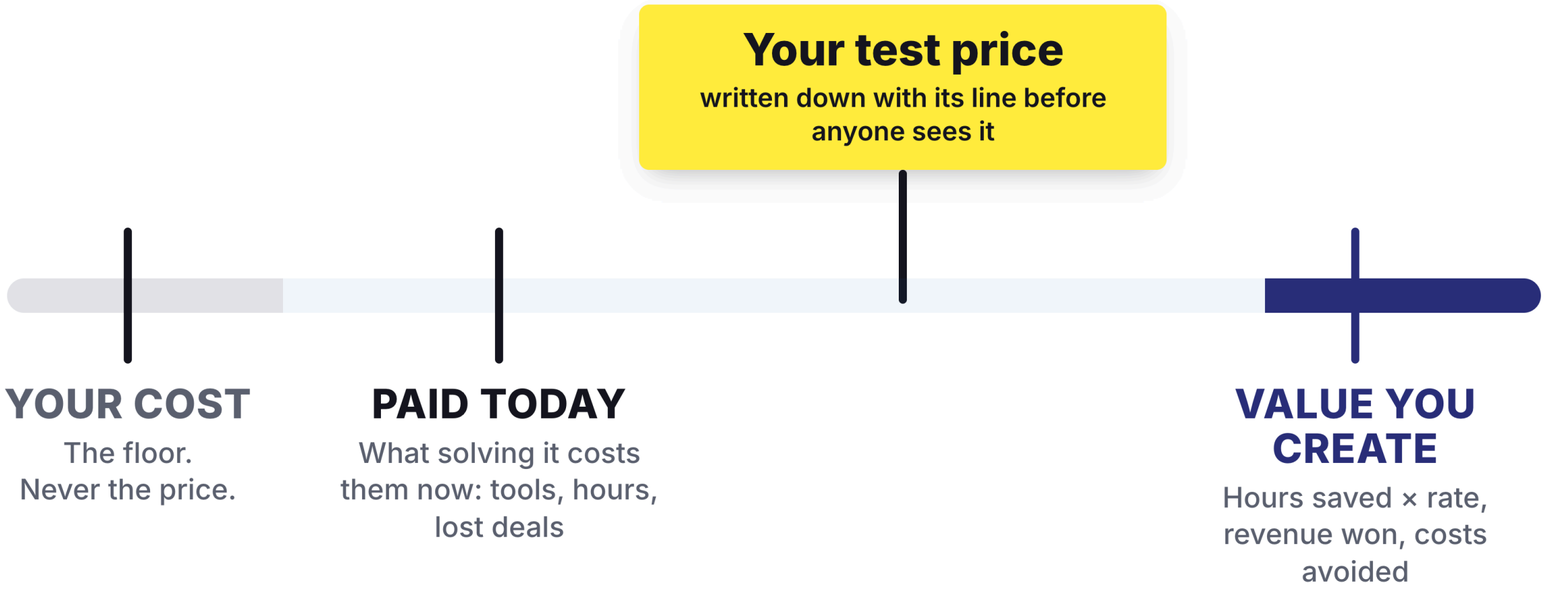
3

How do you know the price is right?

VALUE-BASED PRICING

Price the outcome, not your effort

Rule of thumb, not law. They get 5 to 10 times what they pay you



FRAMEWORK Nagle, Müller & Gruyaert (2023), The Strategy and Tactics of Pricing. Murphy (2012), the 10x rule. Blomfield (2025), YC, an example at about a fifth of the yearly savings. Figure not to scale.

VALUE-BASED PRICING · AN EXAMPLE

Save them $1 million, charge $200,000

Tom Blomfield's example at Y **Y Combinator**. They get 5 times what they pay



A team of 100 becomes 80

$1,000,000 saved in salaries, every year

$200,000, your price

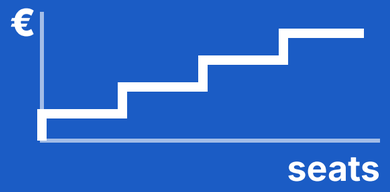
YC Blomfield, T. (2025), The sales playbook for founders, YC Startup Library. His example, not a real customer. Bars to scale. Photo: Telesolutionscallcentr on Pixabay. Logos are trademarks of their owners.

MONETIZATION MODEL

Pick what they pay for

The unit should grow with their value, not with your cost

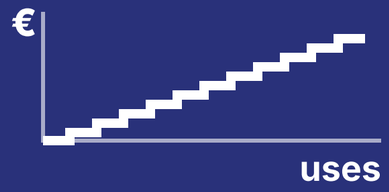
Per seat



Easy to understand and sell. Start here.

`Recruiter seat`

Per use



Per query or call.

`Per nudge sent`

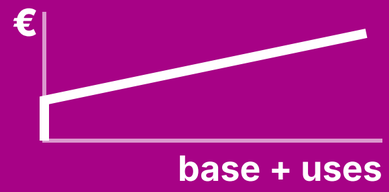
Per outcome



A share of what they save or win.

`Per finalist saved`

Hybrid



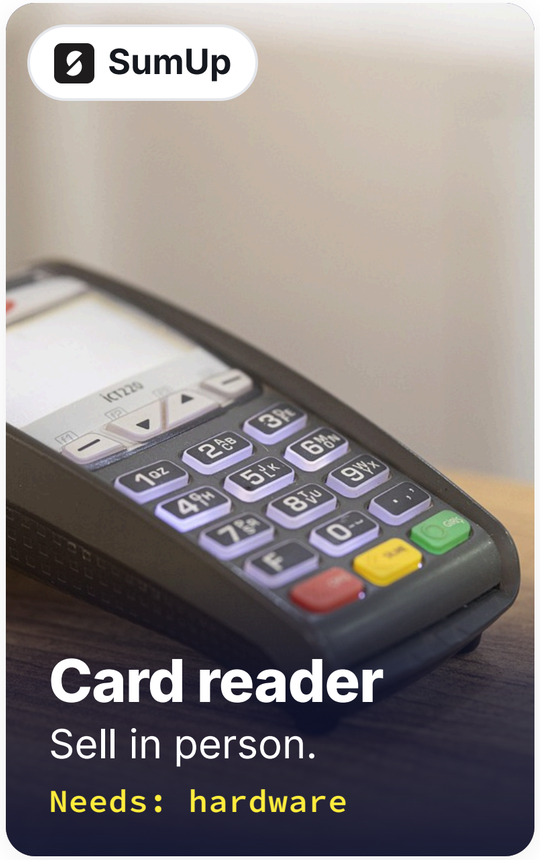
A base fee plus usage.

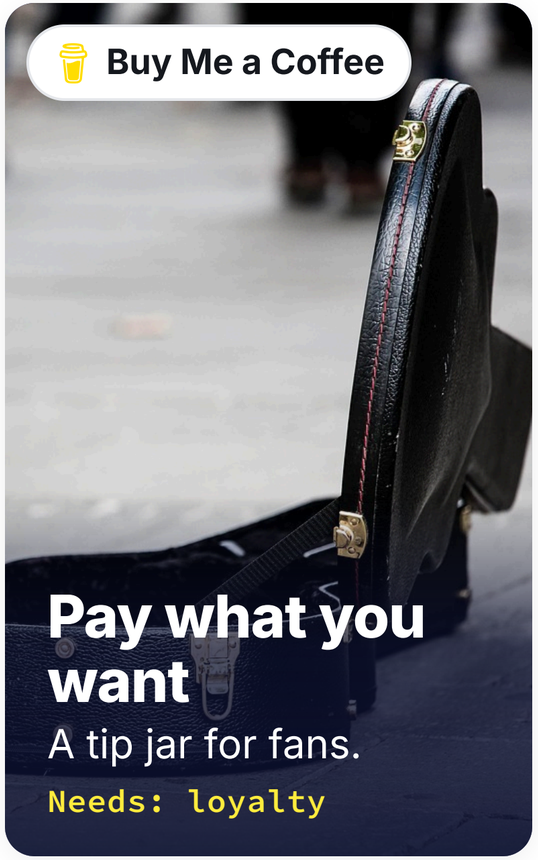
`Seat + nudges`

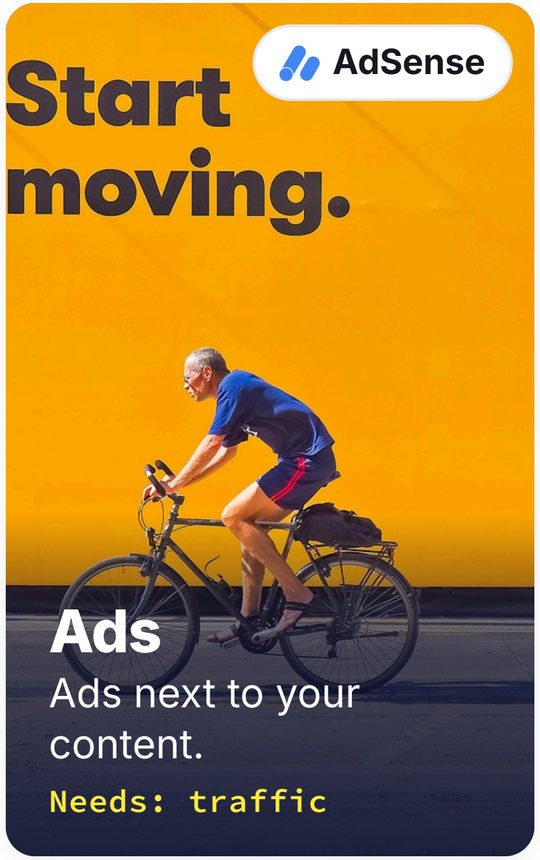
Selling AI? Your **cost per query** is the floor under any per-use price.

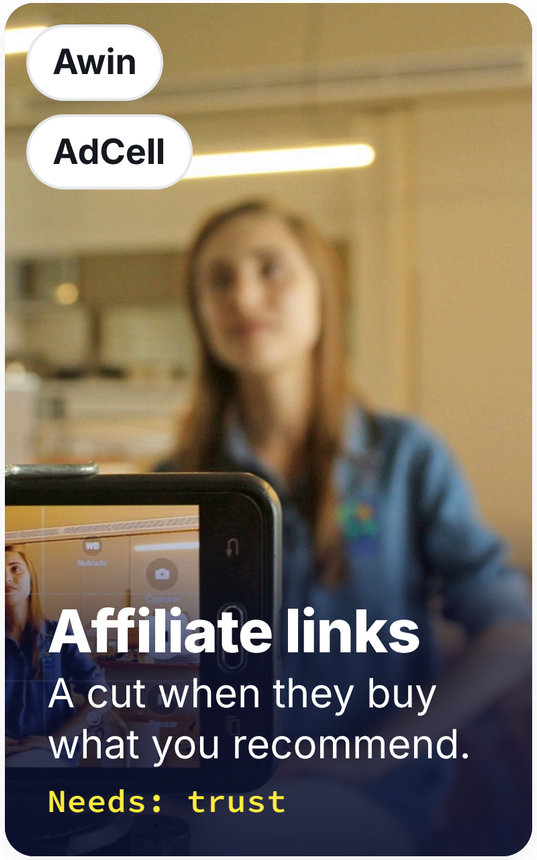
OTHER WAYS TO EARN

Four more ways to earn, each with a catch









Logos are trademarks of their owners. Photos on Pixabay: Engin_Akyurt, AndreasAux, 652234, Feraguz.

B2B ONLY · BASTIAN'S VIEW

If closing €10k takes as long as €1M, go bigger



€10,000

per account, per year

A small pilot turned permanent. Sell performance and features to a head of department.



€1,000,000

per account, per year

Projects a CEO signs off. Sell vision and new opportunities to the CEO.

ARPA is average revenue per account per year. Only applies to B2B. Bars to scale. Photos on Pixabay: This_is_Engineering, patricksommer.



PRICE AS A HYPOTHESIS

Your price is a guess. Write the line first

116 Italian startups, randomized. Teams taught to test earned more

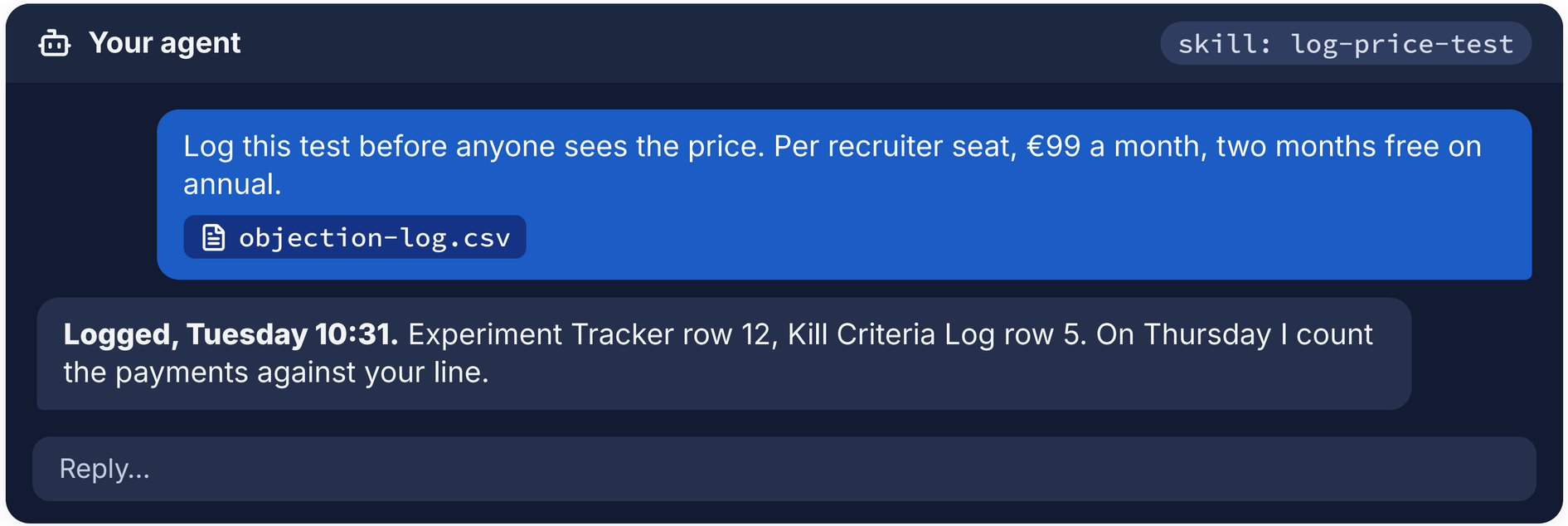
UNIT	Per recruiter seat
PRICE	**€99 a month**
STRUCTURE	Two months free on annual
LINE	**If none of the first 10 named people we send to €99 pays by Thursday, we change the structure, not the amount**
LOGGED	Tuesday, 10:31, before anyone saw it

A line is a result you count, a date, and what you do if you cross it, written **before** the data comes in.

RESEARCH Camuffo, Cordova, Gambardella & Spina (2020), Management Science 66(2), randomized trial. The card and the chat are the made-up recruiting venture, Illustrative. Line form from the Glossary ("Threshold") and framework 03.

WITH YOUR AGENT · NOTHING BY HAND

Your price is a guess. Write the line first



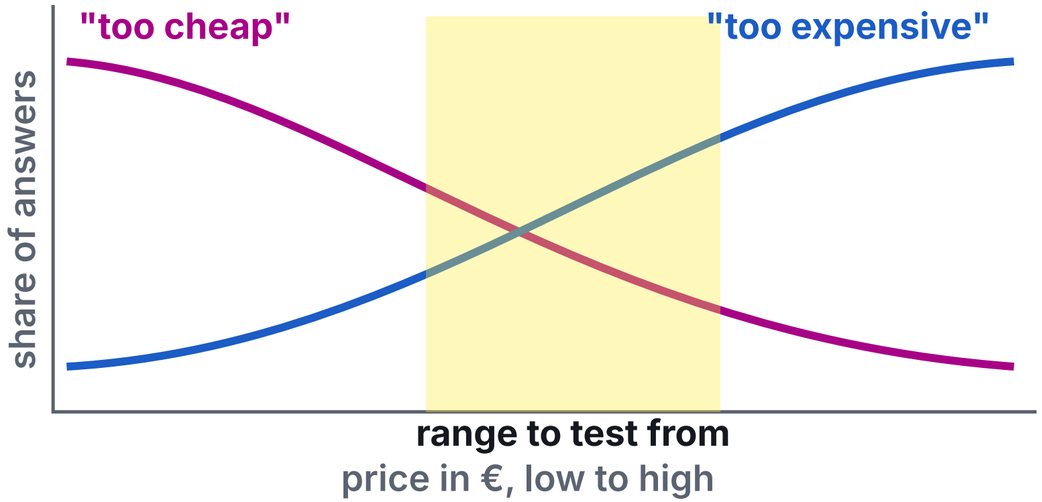
RESEARCH Camuffo, Cordova, Gambardella & Spina (2020), Management Science 66(2), randomized trial. The card and the chat are the made-up recruiting venture, Illustrative. Line form from the Glossary ("Threshold") and framework 03.

STATED WILLINGNESS TO PAY

Survey answers pick the number. Payments test it

Across 77 studies of consumer goods, stated willingness to pay ran 21% above real

1. **At what price is this too expensive to consider?**
2. **At what price is it expensive but worth considering?**
3. **At what price is it a bargain?**
4. **At what price is it so cheap you'd doubt the quality?**



RESEARCH Van Westendorp (1976), ESOMAR Congress. Schmidt & Bijmolt (2020), Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science, meta-analysis. Course material. The curves are a sketch, not data.

THE MOM TEST, FOR PRICES

Ask what they pay today, then ask for money

NEVER ASK

"Would you pay €99 a month for this?"

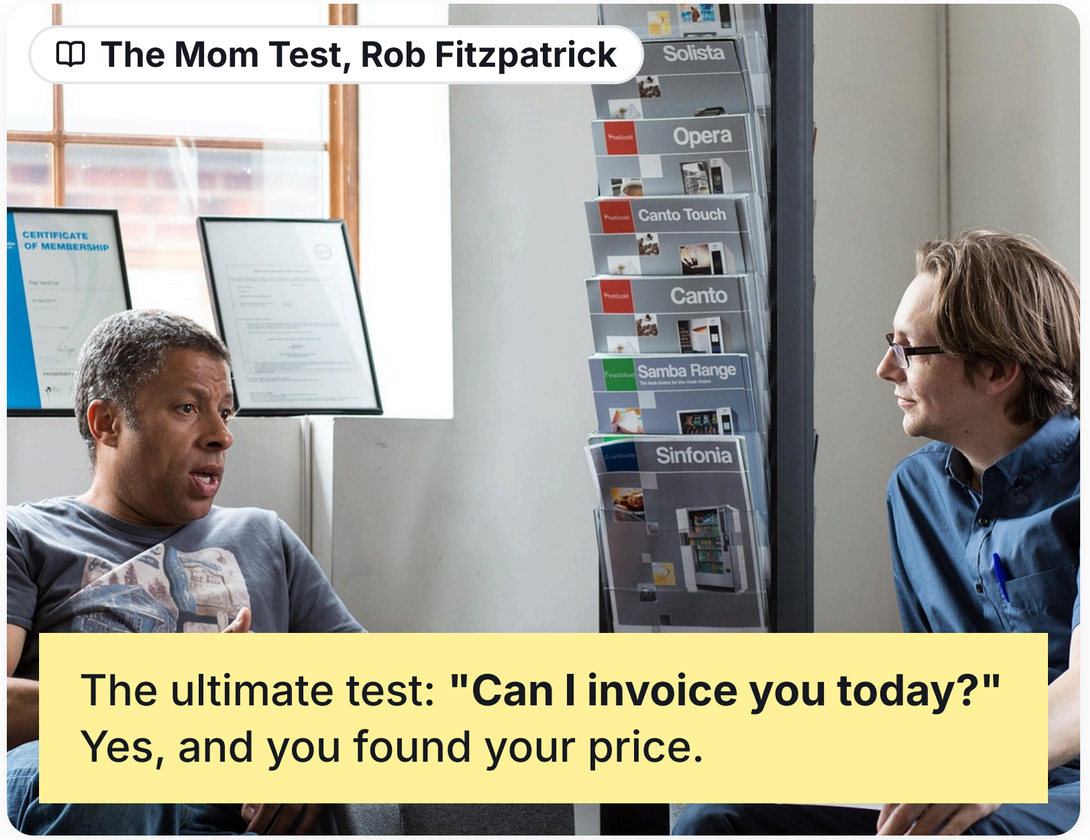
People lie to be polite. Hypotheticals are worthless.

INSTEAD ASK

"What are you currently paying to solve this?"

"What did the last solution you tried cost?"

"What's your budget for solving this problem?"



FRAMEWORK The Mom Test approach to pricing, after Rob Fitzpatrick, The Mom Test (momtestbook.com). Photo: jamesoladujoye on Pixabay.

PRICE STRUCTURES TO TEST

Test the structure before the amount

In the made-up exemplar, every price objection was about structure

Founding member
"First 10 customers lock in their price."

Rewards the early

Annual prepay
Two months free for a year upfront.

All-annual firms churned 80% less

Three tiers
Three options. Make the middle your target.

Course rule of thumb

Money-back guarantee
"30 days, full refund, no questions asked."

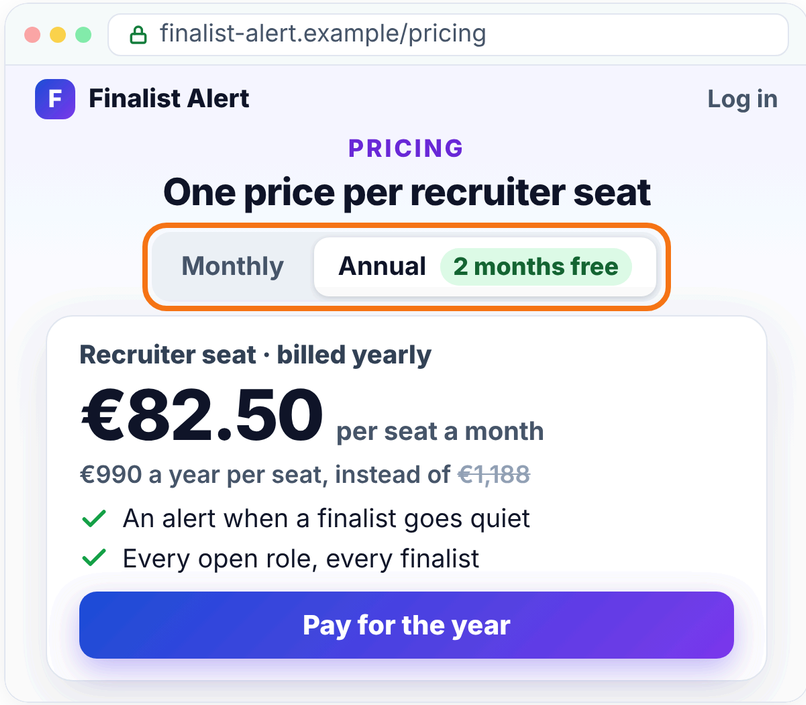
One seller: under 2% refunds

Paid pilot
Fixed scope, 2 to 4 weeks, then recurring.

Paid = taken seriously

Value metric
Price grows with what they get.

You grow when they grow



Data in the card feet, ProfitWell (2019), contract length and churn, a correlation, and McKenzie (2007), refunds of one software seller. YC, Blomfield (2025), on paid pilots. Glossary, "Pilot". Objection Log exemplar and pricing page made up.

OBJECTIONS ARE DATA

Answer "too expensive" with "compared to what?"

Usually it's budget, not value. Dig in

1. **Anchor high, explain value first**
   "Agencies save €990 a seat a month. We charge €99."
2. **State the price, then stop**
   "It's €99 a seat a month." Then silence.
3. **Handle "too expensive" with curiosity**
   "Too expensive compared to what?"
4. **Close or schedule the next step**
   Always leave with a commitment.



ILLUSTRATIVE Prices of the made-up recruiting venture. Photo: kc0uvb on Pixabay.

NOW YOU · 3 MINUTES

Now you: write your price test

- [ ] **Unit:** seat, use, outcome or once
- [ ] **Price:** between what they pay today and your value
- [ ] **Structure:** one, from the six
- [ ] **Line:** count, date, what you do

3:00

OUTPUT

One sentence, ready to log

INPUT 1 OF 4 · PRICE IT · THE ANSWERS

Price it: from value, tested against a line

1

How do you set the price?

From the outcome they get, not your effort. They get 5 to 10 times what they pay

2

What do they pay for?

A unit that grows with their value, not with your cost

3

How do you know the price is right?

You test it: a line first, then ask for money, the structure before the amount

INPUT 2 OF 4 · CHAPTER 4 OF 9

Sell it: the ask inside the product

Move the ask into the product, cut the path to paid and sell the same thing twice.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Price it: a price from value, tested~~

04 **Sell it: the ask inside the product**

05 **Run it: checkout, webhook and deploy**

06 **Protect it: keep the money legal**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

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INPUT 2 OF 4 · SELL IT · THREE QUESTIONS

Who asks them to pay?

1

Why do most teams never get paid?

2

Where does the ask go?

3

Which revenue counts most?



FROM ACTIVATED TO PAID

Most teams never ask. The ask is a feature

Most teams lose them here. Put the ask in the product.

ACTIVATED	SEES VALUE	ASKED TO PAY	PAID
Reached the **outcome** you promise	Sees it **worked** for them	The ask shows **right there**, with the price	Checkout, receipt, **recorded**

Count the steps from yes to paid. Cut every one you can.

LIVE DEMO · QUACKSYNC PRO

Put the ask where they reach the outcome

Duck review podcast for shower thoughts

1

A podcast where two ducks review shower thoughts, ten minutes, every Monday

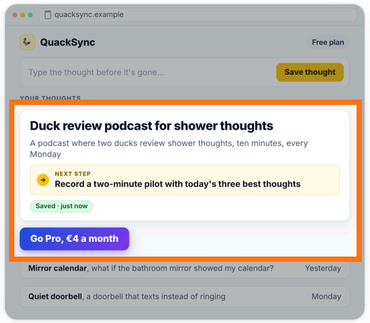
NEXT STEP

Record a two-minute pilot with today's three best thoughts

Saved · just now

Go Pro, €4 a month

2



1 **The outcome**

2 **The ask, right there**

3 One click to checkout

Not on a pricing page they never visit. Under the result they just got.

ILLUSTRATIVE QuackSync, the demo app built with a coding agent in Prototyping (M06), extended in this module. Screen prototyped for this course from the local build, same thought and same price.



FRICTION AUDIT

Count the steps from yes to paid

Every hour of delay increases the chance of ghosting

BY HAND · 8 STEPS · 3 NEED A FOUNDER (MAGENTA)



IN THE PRODUCT · 3 STEPS · NO FOUNDER



FOLLOW-UPS

Write the follow-up once, then let it run

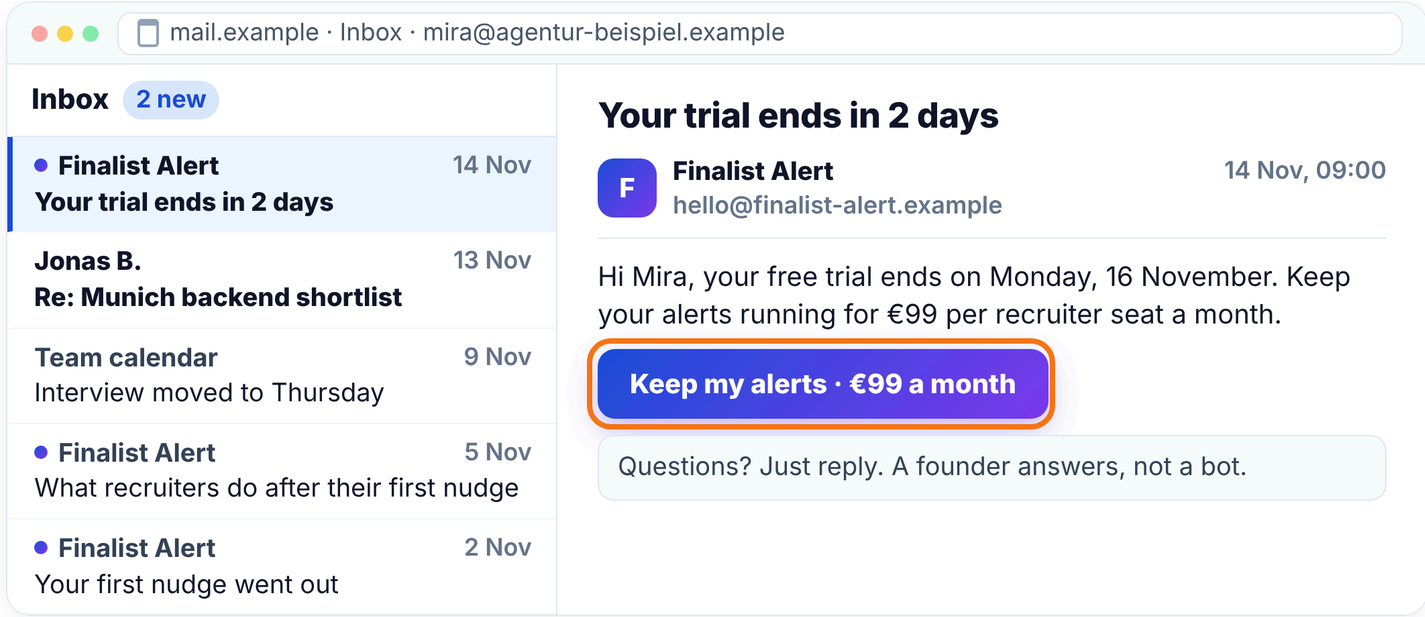
The follow-up of First users (M08), written once, sent by the product

Day 0
Reached the outcome
Email: "Your first nudge went out"

Day 3
Back again?
Email: what others do next

Day 12
Trial ends in 2 days
Email with the price and the link

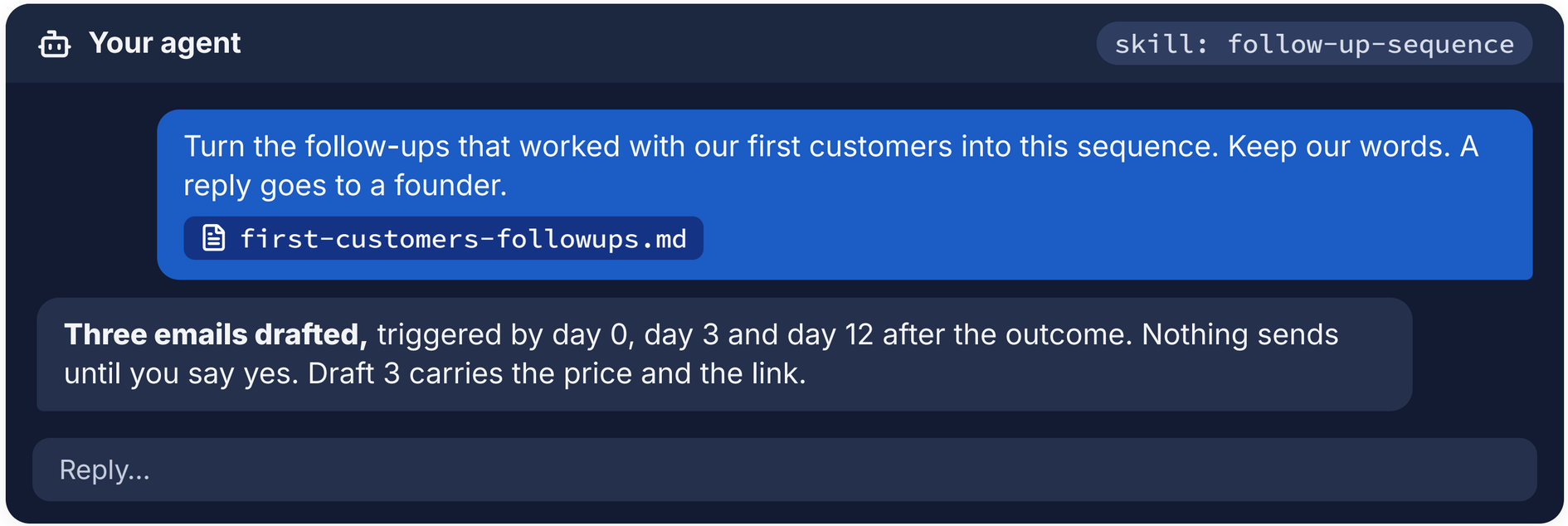
Day 14
Paid or not
Reply goes to a founder



ILLUSTRATIVE Made-up sequence, inbox and chat for the recruiting venture, prototyped for this course. The rule of First users (M08), follow up until yes or no.

WITH YOUR AGENT · NOTHING BY HAND

Write the follow-up once, then let it run

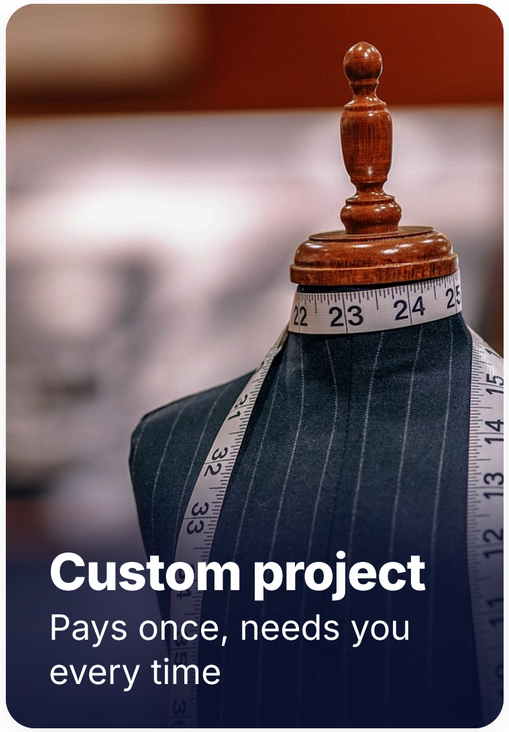


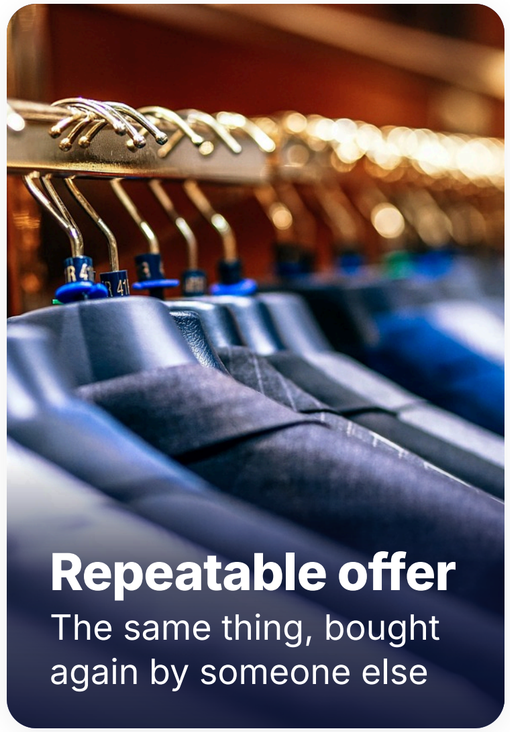
ILLUSTRATIVE Made-up sequence, inbox and chat for the recruiting venture, prototyped for this course. The rule of First users (M08), follow up until yes or no.

REVENUE QUALITY

Sell the same thing twice

Repeatable revenue ranks above consulting-style projects



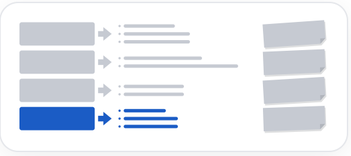


The second sale needs a new proposal? You sold a project.



Bar height: rank in revenue quality, not an amount

FRAMEWORK Glossary, "Revenue quality" and "Traction". GRADING_RUBRIC, "repeatable revenue ranks above consulting-style projects". Photos: StockSnap on Pixabay.



SELLING B2B

Invoice buyers? Let the order form write the invoice

1 **Order form.** In the product. Company, contact, plan.

Finalist Alert · Order

Order a recruiter seat

Company

Agentur Beispiel GmbH

Contact

accounts@agentur-beispiel.example

Plan

Recruiter seat €99 a month

Order and send the invoice

2 **Numbered invoice.** Sent automatically, number 001 and up.

3 **Paid by transfer.** Recorded against the invoice number.

Finalist Alert GbR · Musterstraße 1 · 80333 München **Issued by the order form**

Agentur Beispiel GmbH
10115 Berlin

Invoice 014
1 Dec 2026

Recruiter seat, December 2026 **€99.00**

Steuerbefreiung für Kleinunternehmer nach § 19 UStG.

Paid by transfer, reference 014, recorded

ILLUSTRATIVE Order form and invoice of the made-up recruiting venture, screen prototyped for this deck. Names and numbers made up. Invoice fields on slide 65.



NOW YOU · 2 MINUTES

Now you: count your steps to paid

- [ ] Write every step from "yes" to "paid"
- [ ] Mark each step that needs a founder
- [ ] Circle the one you cut first

2:00

OUTPUT

Your step count and the first cut

INPUT 2 OF 4 · SELL IT · THE ANSWERS

Sell it: the product asks for you

1

Why do most teams never get paid?

They never ask. The ask is a feature

2

Where does the ask go?

Where users reach the outcome, with few steps from yes to paid

3

Which revenue counts most?

The same thing sold twice. Repeatable revenue ranks above projects

Run it: checkout, webhook and deploy

A checkout, a webhook and a deploy from your repository, built with your coding agent.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Price it: a price from value, tested~~

04 ~~Sell it: the ask inside the product~~

05 **Run it: checkout, webhook and deploy**

06 **Protect it: keep the money legal**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: Revenue Sprint

09 Case discussion

INPUT 3 OF 4 · RUN IT · THREE QUESTIONS

How does it run without you?

1

Who handles the card data?

2

How does your app learn that someone paid?

3

How do you ship without breaking it?

VIBE CODING

Sometimes, you just don't feel the vibes

Pivot inside a repository

Poor prompts

Low control of data flows

Conflicting instructions

I have no idea what I'm doing

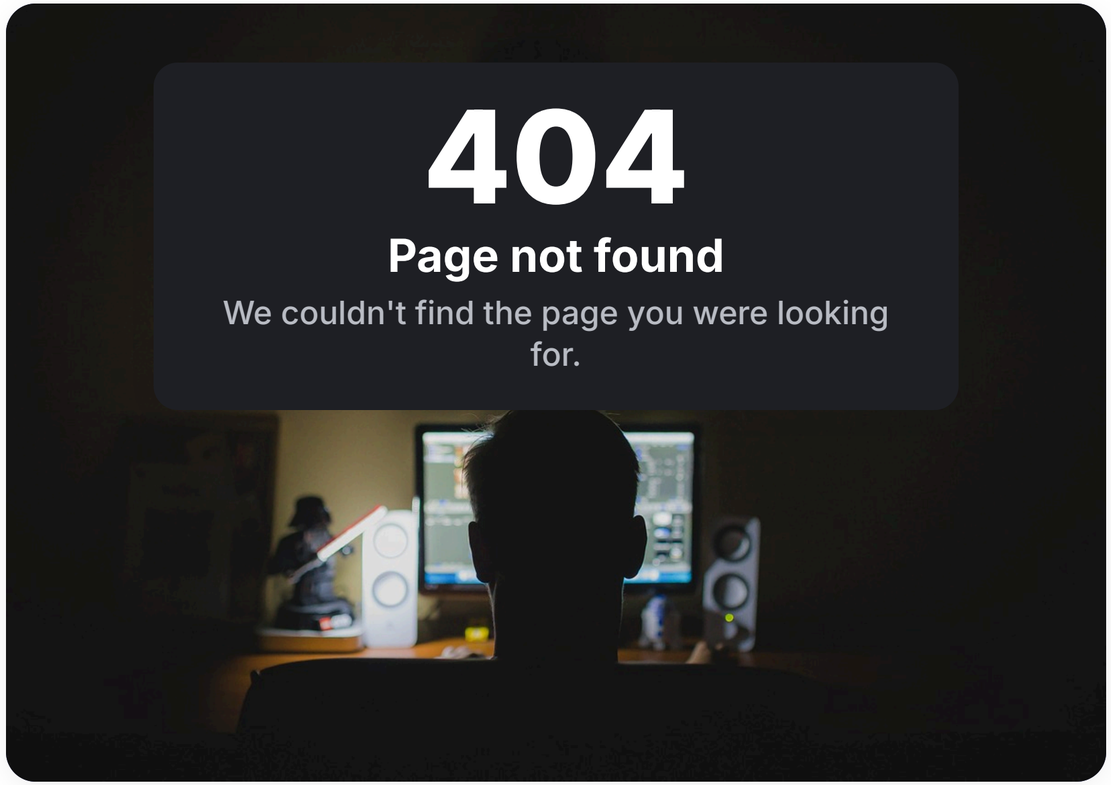
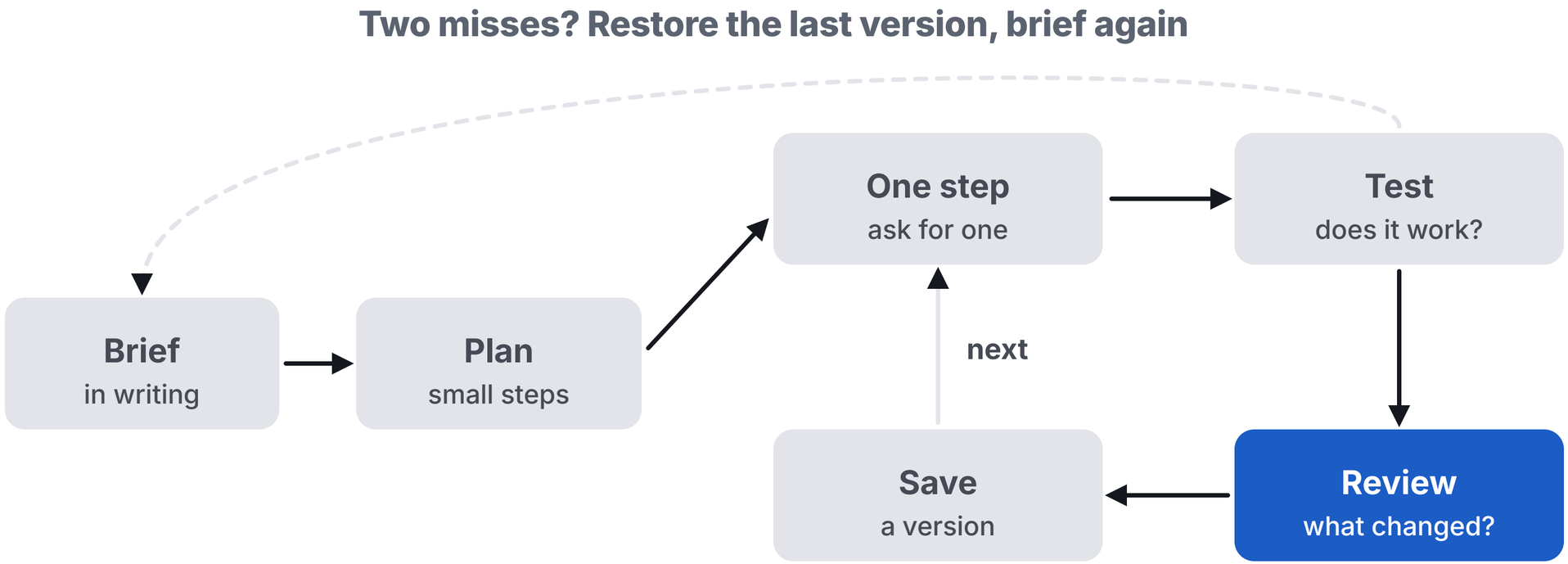
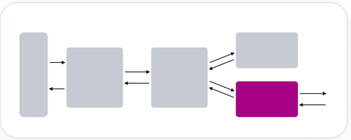


Photo: tookapic on Pixabay.

PREVIOUSLY · PROTOTYPING (M06)

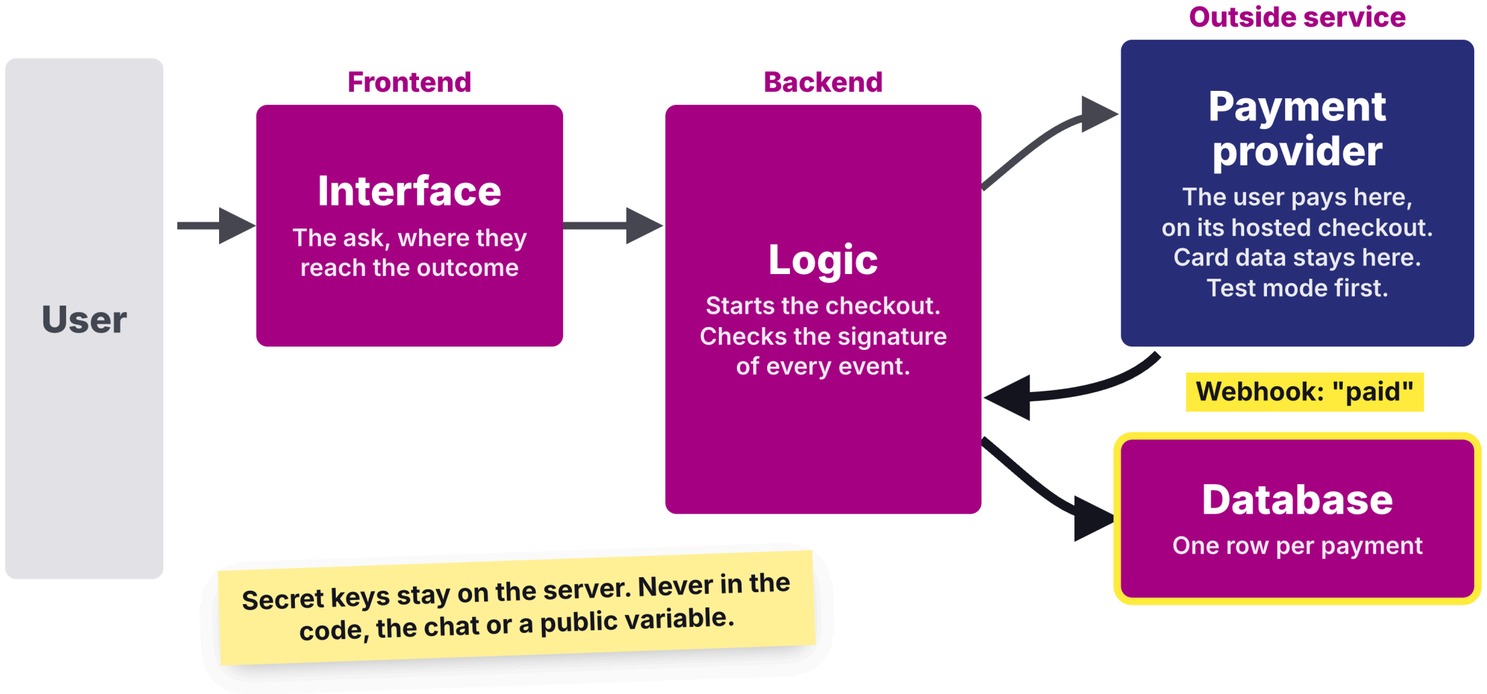
The same loop. Brief, one step, test, review, save

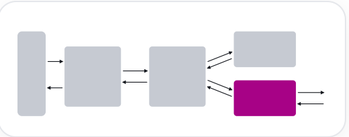




EVERY APPLICATION EVER

Every application ever, now with a payment provider

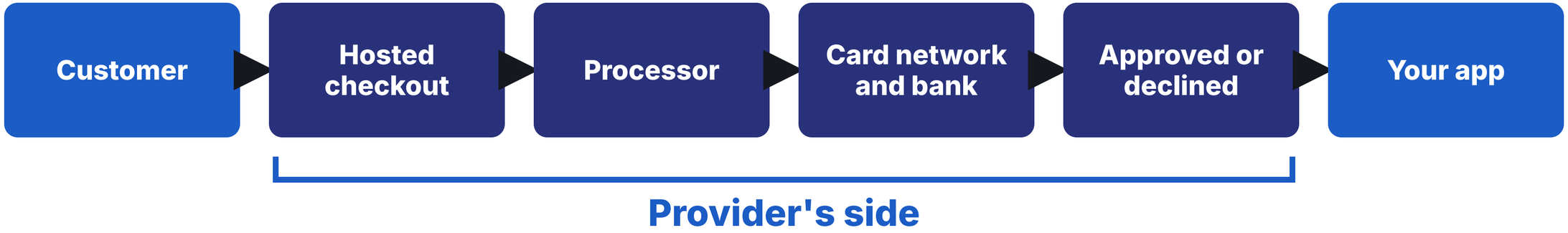




PAYMENT GATEWAY

Let the provider hold the card data

Card data on your server makes you a compliance project (PCI DSS)

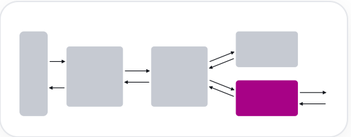




Test mode first. Fake card numbers, real flow, no real money. Card 4242 4242 4242 4242.

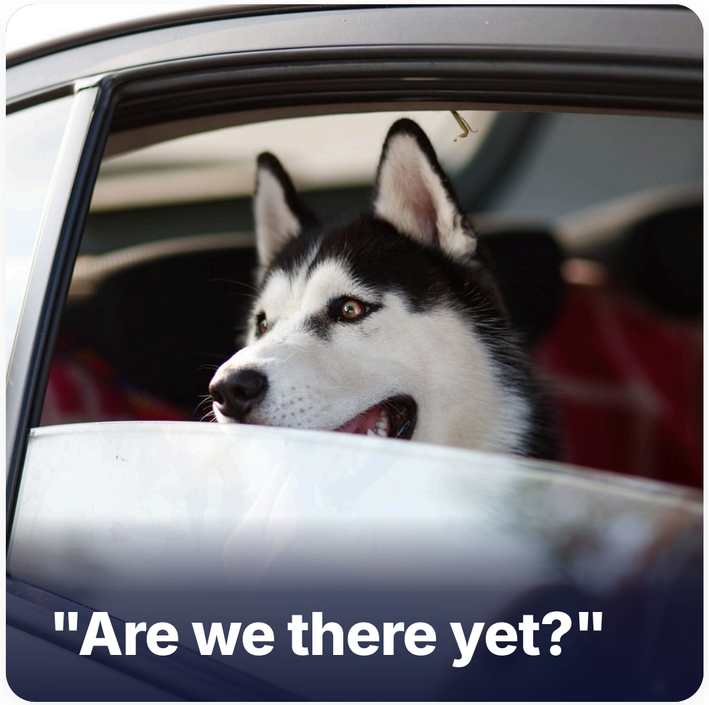
Stripe · Adyen · Dutch · Braintree · Square · Klarna · Swedish · PayPal Checkout

DATA PCI Security Standards Council, PCI DSS. Stripe docs, integration security guide, Checkout and testing. Adyen and Klarna company pages. Tools as of October 2026. Checkout prototyped for this course, Illustrative, Stripe's looks different. Logos are trademarks of their owners.



WEBHOOKS

Stop asking "are we there yet?" Let them call you



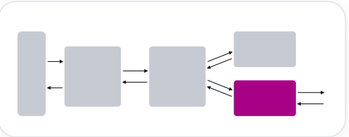
ASKING EVERY MINUTE

"Paid yet?" No. | "Paid yet?" No. | "Paid yet?" No. | "Paid yet?" Yes!

BEING TOLD ONCE

→ "Payment completed"

Photo: anvel on Pixabay.



A WEBHOOK, STEP 1 OF 3 · METHOD AND TARGET

A webhook is a POST with a payload

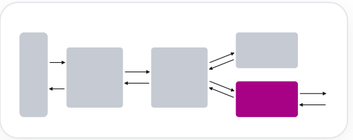
Incoming request, shortened

```
POST https://quacksync.example/webhook
Stripe-Signature: t=1760000000,v1=5257a8…

{
  "id": "evt_1Qx…",
  "type": "checkout.session.completed",
  "data": { "object": {
    "id": "cs_test_a1B2…",
    "payment_status": "paid",
    "amount_total": 400,
    "currency": "eur"
  } }
}
```

Method and target. POST to an address you choose. The provider calls it.

DATA Course material, retaken with a payment event. Event shape after Stripe docs, "Receive Stripe events" and "Fulfill orders", shortened, values made up.



A WEBHOOK, STEP 2 OF 3 · SIGNATURE

A webhook is a POST with a payload

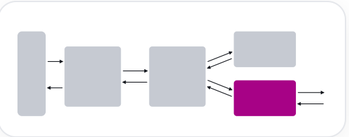
Incoming request, shortened

```
POST https://quacksync.example/webhook
Stripe-Signature: t=1760000000,v1=5257a8…

{
  "id": "evt_1Qx…",
  "type": "checkout.session.completed",
  "data": { "object": {
    "id": "cs_test_a1B2…",
    "payment_status": "paid",
    "amount_total": 400,
    "currency": "eur"
  } }
}
```

Signature. Proves the provider sent it. Check it first.

DATA Course material, retaken with a payment event. Event shape after Stripe docs, "Receive Stripe events" and "Fulfill orders", shortened, values made up.



A WEBHOOK, STEP 3 OF 3 · PAYLOAD

A webhook is a POST with a payload

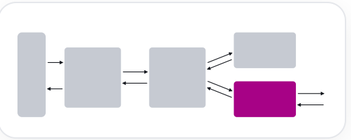
Incoming request, shortened

```
POST https://quacksync.example/webhook
Stripe-Signature: t=1760000000,v1=5257a8…

{
  "id": "evt_1Qx…",
  "type": "checkout.session.completed",
  "data": { "object": {
    "id": "cs_test_a1B2…",
    "payment_status": "paid",
    "amount_total": 400,
    "currency": "eur"
  } }
}
```

Payload. The data you work with. One payment.

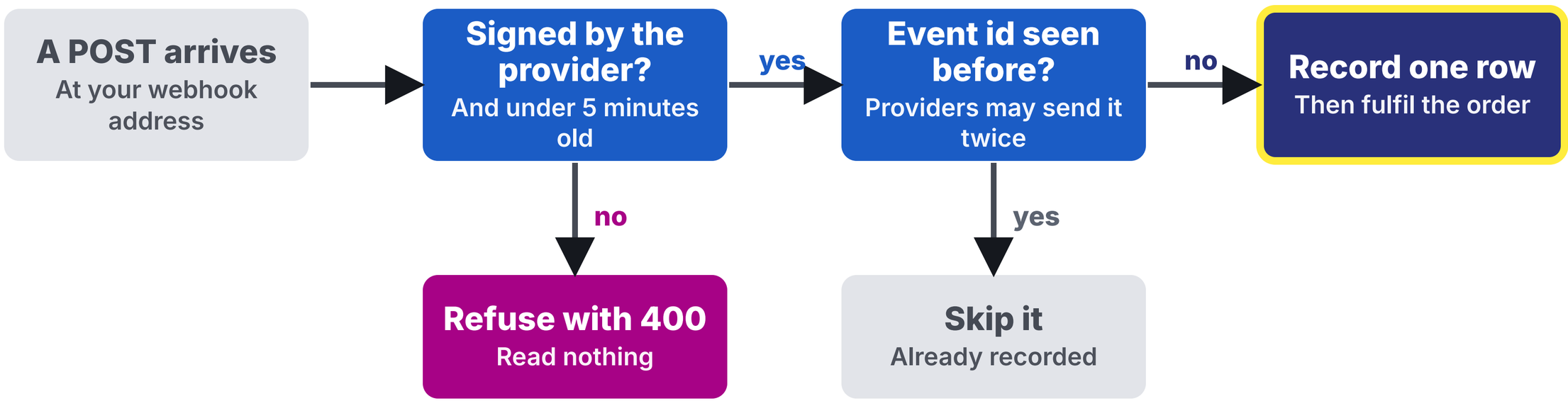
DATA Course material, retaken with a payment event. Event shape after Stripe docs, "Receive Stripe events" and "Fulfill orders", shortened, values made up.



WEBHOOKS YOU CAN TRUST

Trust the signature, record each event once

Anyone can POST to your address. Only the provider can sign



DATA Stripe docs, "Receive Stripe events in your webhook endpoint" ("might occasionally receive the same event more than once") and "Fulfill orders".

NOW YOU · 1 MINUTE

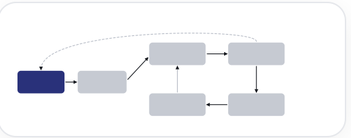
Now you: write the three webhook rules into your brief

- [ ] Check the signature before you read anything
- [ ] Record each event once, by its id
- [ ] Fulfil from the webhook, not the success page

1:00

OUTPUT

Three lines in your agent brief

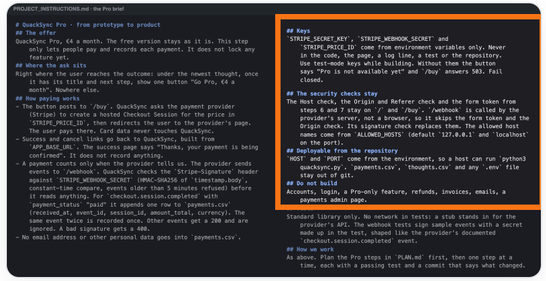


LIVE DEMO · QUACKSYNC PRO · THE BRIEF

Brief first. What to build, what not to build

```
## Keys
`STRIPE_SECRET_KEY`, `STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET` and
    `STRIPE_PRICE_ID` come from environment variables only. Never
    in the code, the page, a log line, a test or the repository.
    Use test-mode keys while building. Without them the button
    says "Pro is not available yet" and `/buy` answers 503. Fail
    closed.
## The security checks stay
The Host check, the Origin and Referer check and the form token from
    steps 6 and 7 stay on `/` and `/buy`. `/webhook` is called by the
    provider's server, not a browser, so it skips the form token and the
    Origin check. Its signature check replaces them. The allowed host
    names come from `ALLOWED_HOSTS` (default `127.0.0.1` and `localhost`
    on the port).
## Deployable from the repository
`HOST` and `PORT` come from the environment, so a host can run `python3
    quacksync.py`. `payments.csv`, `thoughts.csv` and any `.env` file
    stay out of git.
## Do not build
Accounts, login, a Pro-only feature, refunds, invoices, emails, a
    payments admin page.
```

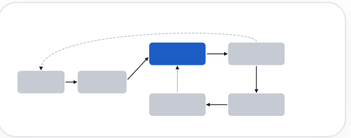
1



1. **The brief**
2. One step at a time
3. The review
4. The payment

Keys, the signature check and "a payment counts only when the provider tells us" are in the brief. The agent can't guess them.

ILLUSTRATIVE The founder's brief, written before any code. QuackSync, the course demo app, built by a coding agent on 19 October 2026 from the brief, records not edited. Test-mode values made up.



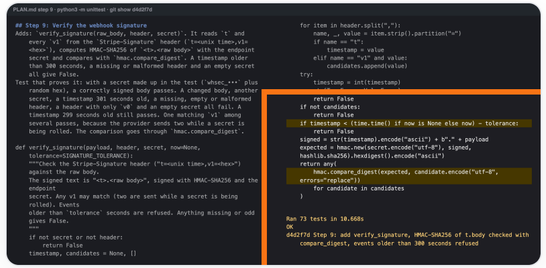
LIVE DEMO · QUACKSYNC PRO · ONE STEP

One step, one test, one commit

```
        return False
    if not candidates:
        return False
    if timestamp < (time.time() if now is None else now) - tolerance:
        return False
    signed = str(timestamp).encode("ascii") + b"." + payload
    expected = hmac.new(secret.encode("utf-8"), signed,
    hashlib.sha256).hexdigest().encode("ascii")
    return any(
        hmac.compare_digest(expected, candidate.encode("utf-8",
    errors="replace"))
        for candidate in candidates
    )
```

2

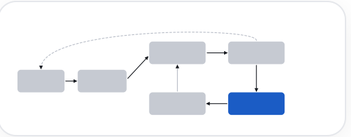
```
Ran 73 tests in 10.668s
OK
d4d2f7d Step 9: add verify_signature, HMAC-SHA256 of t.body checked with
    compare_digest, events older than 300 seconds refused
```



1. The brief
2. **One step at a time**
3. The review
4. The payment

Each step ends green and saved. Two misses? Restore and brief again.

ILLUSTRATIVE The coding agent's step, its test run and its commit. QuackSync, the course demo app, built by a coding agent on 19 October 2026 from the brief, records not edited. Test-mode values made up.



LIVE DEMO · QUACKSYNC PRO · THE REVIEW

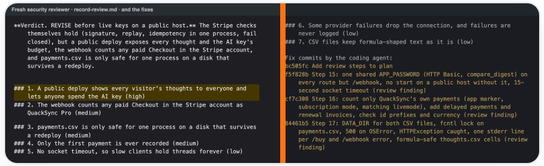
The review caught what the tests missed

Fresh security reviewer · record-review.md · and the fixes

```
**Verdict. REVISE before live keys on a public host.** The Stripe checks
    themselves hold (signature, replay, idempotency in one process, fail
    closed), but a public deploy exposes every thought and the AI key's
    budget, the webhook counts any paid Checkout in the Stripe account,
    and payments.csv is only safe for one process on a disk that
    survives a redeploy.

### 1. A public deploy shows every visitor's thoughts to everyone and
    lets anyone spend the AI key (high)
### 2. The webhook counts any paid Checkout in the Stripe account as
    QuackSync Pro (medium)
### 3. payments.csv is only safe for one process on a disk that survives
    a redeploy (medium)
### 4. Only the first payment is ever recorded (medium)
### 5. No socket timeout, so slow clients hold threads forever (low)
```

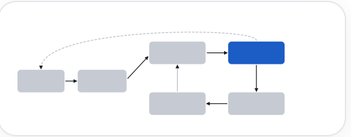
3



1. The brief
2. One step at a time
3. **The review**
4. The payment

Payment code gets a second pair of eyes that did not write it.

ILLUSTRATIVE A fresh reviewer's finding and the fix. QuackSync, the course demo app, built by a coding agent on 19 October 2026 from the brief, records not edited. Test-mode values made up.



LIVE DEMO · QUACKSYNC PRO · THE PAYMENT

A payment becomes a row

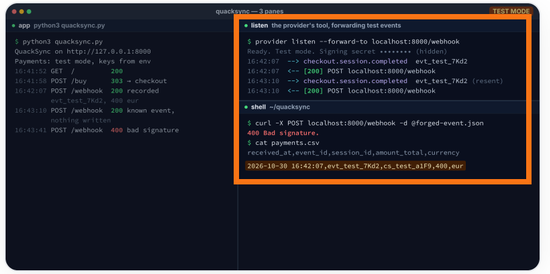
listen the provider's tool, forwarding test events

```
$ provider listen --forward-to localhost:8000/webhook
Ready. Test mode. Signing secret •••••••• (hidden)
16:42:07  --> checkout.session.completed  evt_test_7Kd2
16:42:07  <-- [200] POST localhost:8000/webhook
16:43:10  --> checkout.session.completed  evt_test_7Kd2 (resent)
16:43:10  <-- [200] POST localhost:8000/webhook
```

shell ~/quacksync

```
$ curl -X POST localhost:8000/webhook -d @forged-event.json
400 Bad signature.
$ cat payments.csv
received_at,event_id,session_id,amount_total,currency
2026-10-30 16:42:07,evt_test_7Kd2,cs_test_a1F9,400,eur
```

4



1 The brief

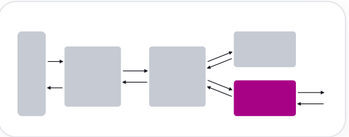
2 One step at a time

3 The review

4 **The payment**

Sent twice, recorded once. Wrong signature, refused.

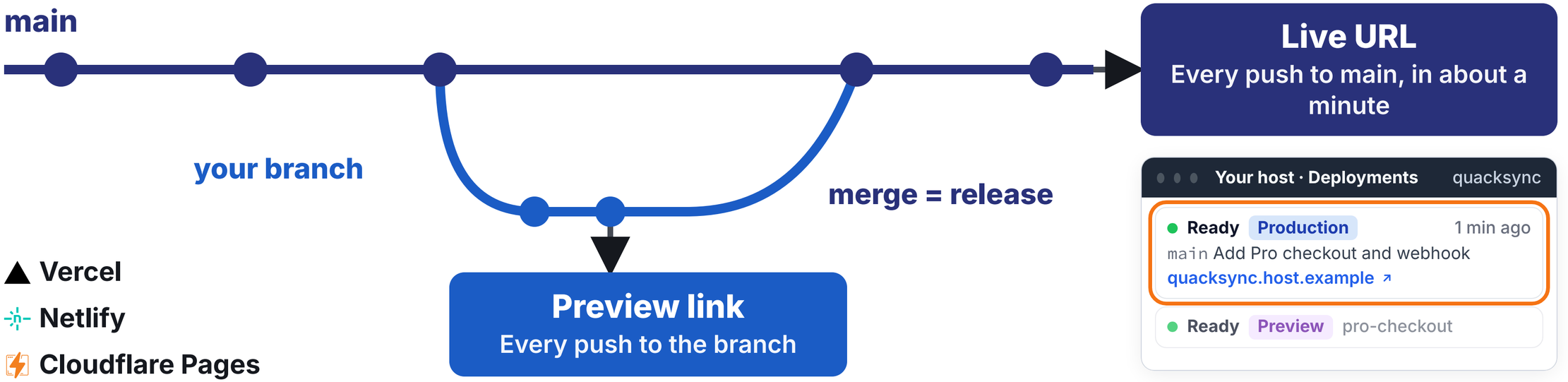
ILLUSTRATIVE QuackSync's live run in test mode, prototyped for this course: a payment provider's tool forwards the payment to the app's webhook. Values made up, keys hidden, Stripe's real tools look different.



DEPLOY

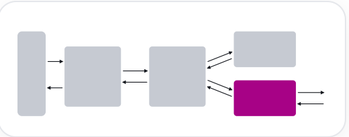
Every push to main goes live

Every other branch gets its own preview link



Test on the preview link. Merge to main. That is your release. Rolling back is going back one commit.

DATA Vercel docs, "Deploying Git repositories". Netlify, Deploy Previews. Cloudflare Pages, Git integration. Tools as of October 2026. Deploy screen prototyped for this course, Illustrative. Logos are trademarks of their owners.



ENVIRONMENT VARIABLES

Keys live in environment variables, never in the code

Never this

```
// In your code. BAD!
const KEY = "sk_live_51H…"
```

Do this instead

```
// In your code. GOOD!
const KEY = process.env.STRIPE_SECRET_KEY
```

⚠ Pushed a key?

Bots scan public repos. Revoke it now, then remove it.

🔒 Changed a key?

It only reaches the next deployment. Redeploy.

🌐 NEXT_PUBLIC_ and friends?

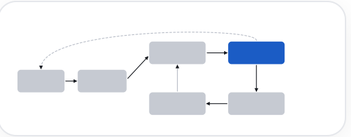
That prefix ships the value to every browser. Never a secret.

Your host · Environment variables

STRIPE_SECRET_KEY	••••••••••••
STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET	••••••••••••
STRIPE_PRICE_ID	price_…

Changes reach the next deployment. **Redeploy**

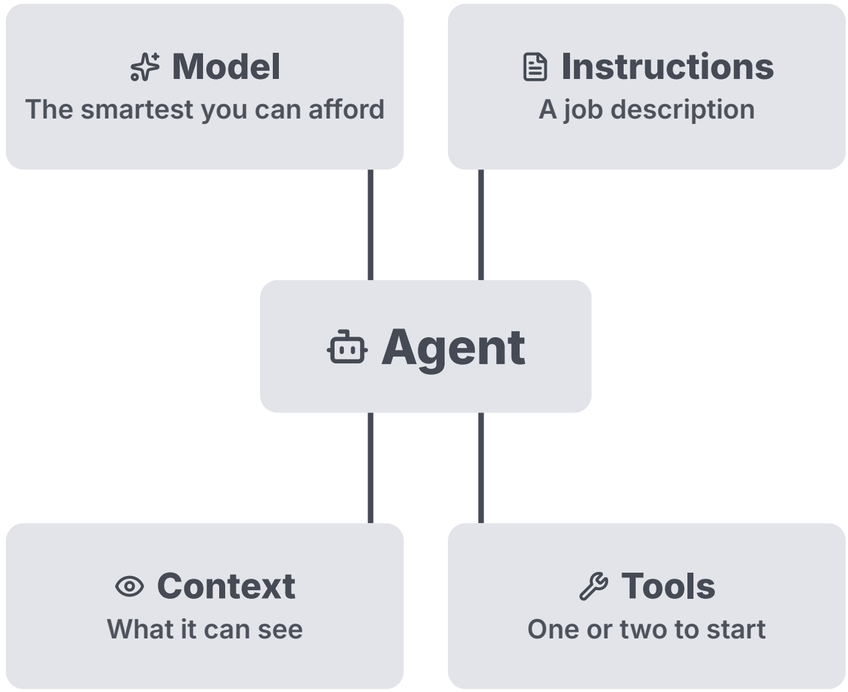
DATA Course material, condensed. Stripe docs, API keys and key best practices. Vercel docs, environment variables. Next.js docs, environment variables. Key shortened and made up. Settings screen prototyped for this deck, Illustrative.



AI AGENTS

Hand one chore to an agent you tested

Ten of your own cases before it touches a customer



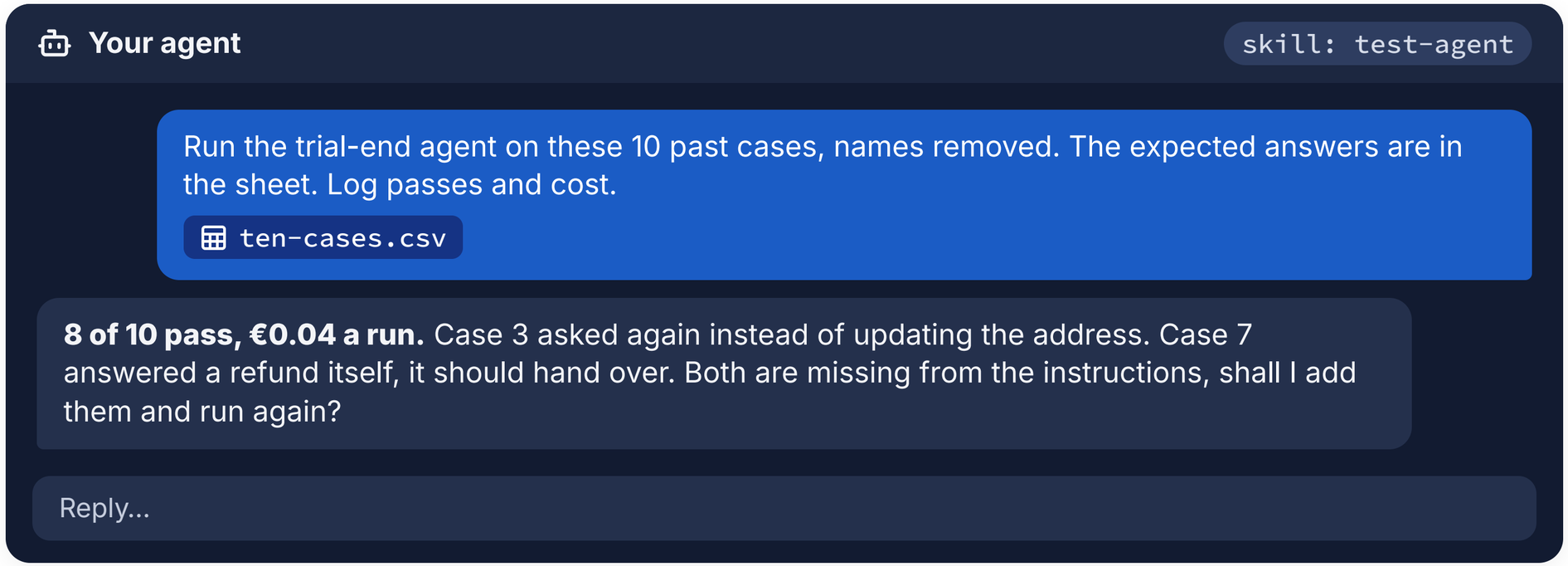
#	Your case	Expected	Got	Pass
1	Agency asks for a refund	Hand to founder	Hand to founder	yes
3	Invoice address changed	Update and confirm	Asked again	no
10	Spam	Ignore	Ignore	yes

Count passes out of 10 and the cost per run. Many fail? Fix the instructions.

DATA Anthropic docs, "Define success criteria and build evaluations". Agent settings. Evaluations, task success and cost per query. Test cases, chat and numbers made up for the recruiting venture, Illustrative.

WITH YOUR AGENT · NOTHING BY HAND

Hand one chore to an agent you tested



DATA Anthropic docs, "Define success criteria and build evaluations". Agent settings. Evaluations, task success and cost per query. Test cases, chat and numbers made up for the recruiting venture, Illustrative.

LEAVING THE APP BUILDER

Switch when the tool becomes the constraint, not when boredom sets in

NOT A REASON

A ~~You want a fresh design~~

B ~~You think another tool is a little better~~

C ~~You think it improves your metrics~~

TIME TO SWITCH

A Your development is blocked by system limitations

B You can afford to spend 10x time on building

C You know what you are building

NOW YOU · 2 MINUTES

Now you: name your chore and its ten test cases

- [ ] One chore that eats founder hours every week
- [ ] Ten real past cases from your records
- [ ] What a good answer is, for each

2:00

OUTPUT

A chore and ten cases, ready to test

INPUT 3 OF 4 · RUN IT · THE ANSWERS

Run it: the provider holds the card, a webhook tells you

1

Who handles the card data?

The payment provider. Card data on your server makes you a compliance project

2

How does your app learn that someone paid?

A webhook. Trust its signature and record each event once

3

How do you ship without breaking it?

One step, one test, one commit. A push to main goes live, keys stay out of the code

INPUT 4 OF 4 · CHAPTER 6 OF 9

Protect it: keep the money legal

The ten-minute setup that keeps your first euros clean, as education, not legal advice.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Price it: a price from value, tested~~

04 ~~Sell it: the ask inside the product~~

05 ~~Run it: checkout, webhook and deploy~~

06 **Protect it: keep the money legal**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: Revenue Sprint

09 Case discussion

INPUT 4 OF 4 · PROTECT IT · THREE QUESTIONS

What must be in place before euro one?

1

Who is liable for the team's debts?

2

What do you set up before you sell?

3

Who owns the code?

YOUR LEGAL FORM

You're a GbR already. Everyone is liable

Every founder answers for every team debt with private money

You are here

GbR

By default, the moment you sell together

eGbR

Registered, since 2024

UG or GmbH

UG from €1, GmbH €25,000

Personal liability, your private money

Limited to the company

REGISTRATION

Register once, then sell

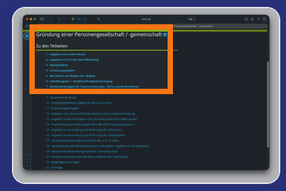


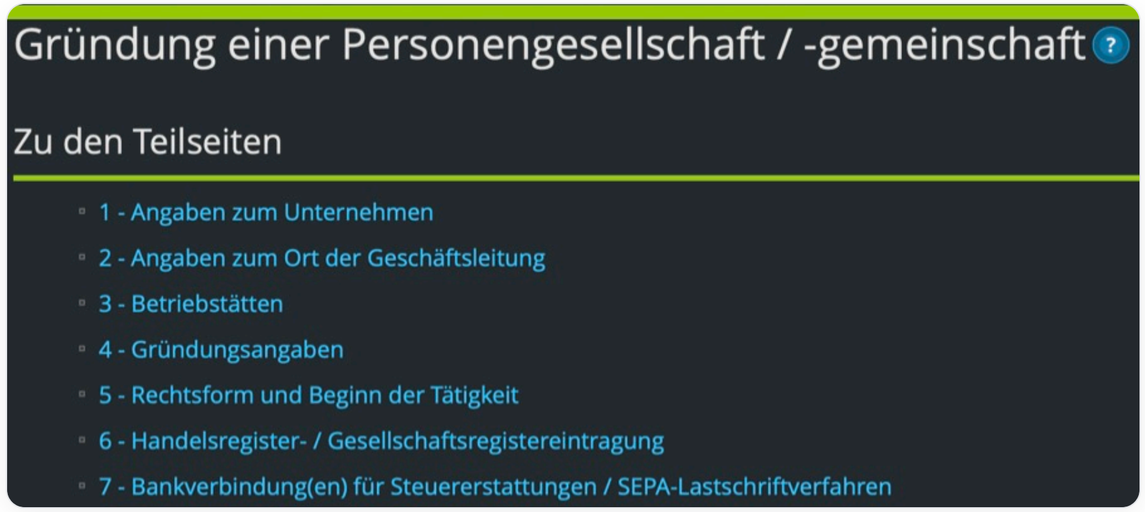
Gewerbeamt

A trade registers when it starts. About €20 to €30 per founder in Munich. Liberal professions skip it.

Tax office

ELSTER, "Fragebogen zur steuerlichen Erfassung", within a month. No fee. The tax number comes by post.





DATA § 14 GewO, § 138 AO, elster.de, IHK München, opened 19 October 2026. Screenshot of the ELSTER questionnaire, November 2024, cropped. Photo: alfredhofmeister on Pixabay. Not legal advice.

§ 19 USTG

No VAT while you're small, but every invoice says why

In your first year up to €25,000. After that, €25,000 last year and €100,000 this year



ON EVERY INVOICE

Both names and addresses · your tax number (above €250) · date · what you sold · the total · "Steuerbefreiung für Kleinunternehmer nach § 19 UStG" · a number from 001, the course's rule

DATA § 19 UStG, § 33 and § 34a UStDV, BMF letters of 18 March and 15 October 2025, opened 19 October 2026, legal file of First users (M08), L02 to L05, L08. Not legal advice.

MONEY AND RECEIPTS

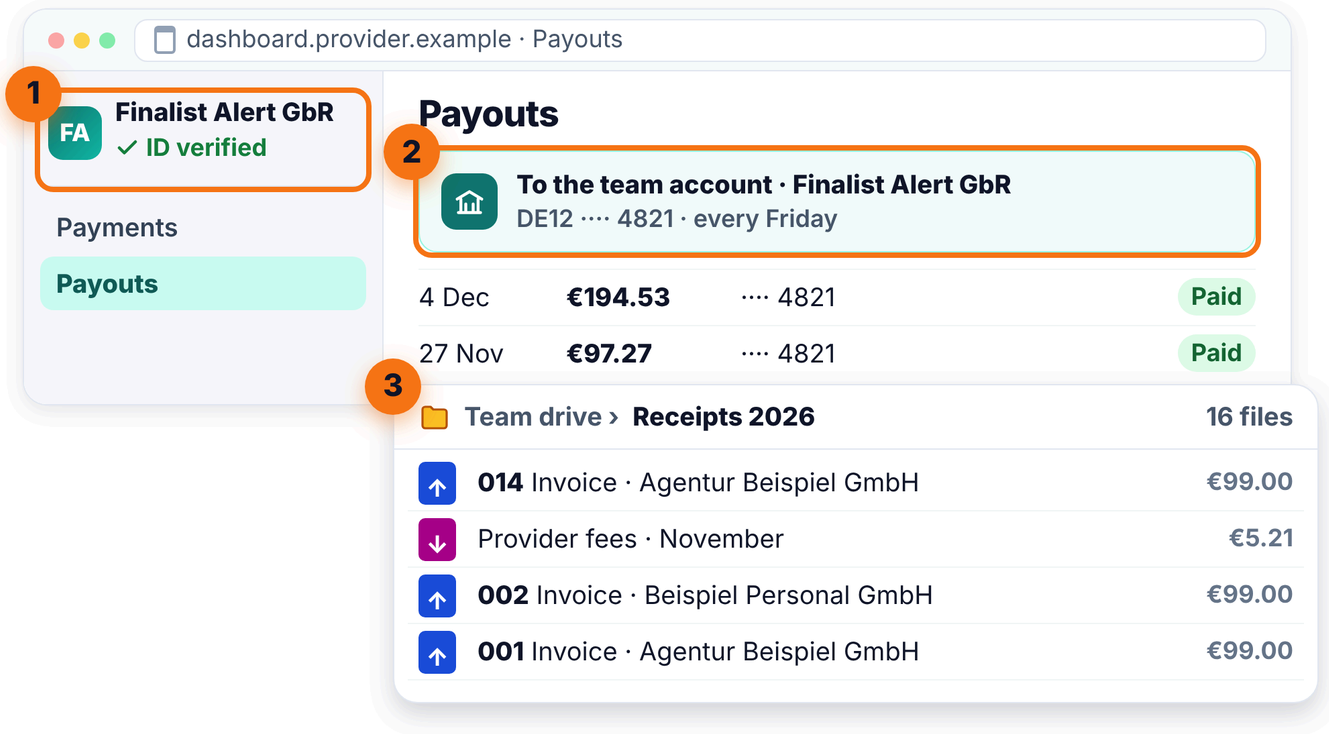
One team account, receipts from euro one

A customer pays

1 **Payment account**
In the team's name. ID checked before payouts

2 **Team bank account**
Never a private one
~~A founder's private account~~

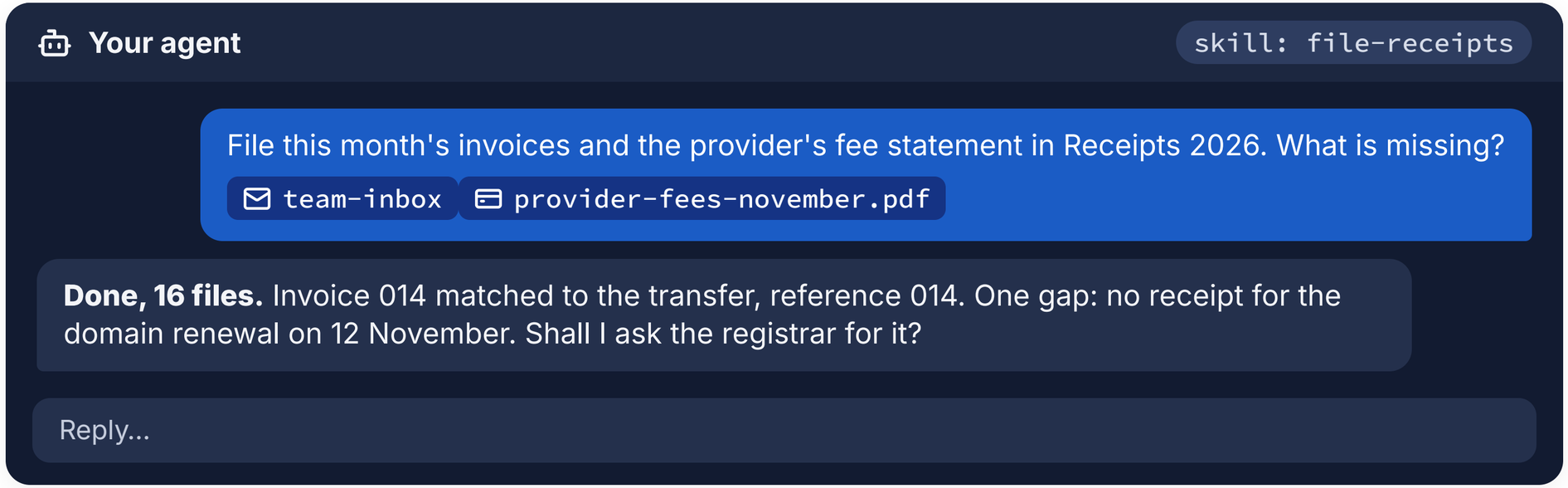
3 **One receipts folder**
Every invoice in and out, kept 8 years. A bookkeeping tool from about 10 receipts a month



DATA § 147 AO and § 14b UStG, 8 years since 2025. Stripe docs, account set-up and KYC. Course material, the ten-receipt rule is Bastian's. Screens and chat prototyped for this course, Illustrative. Not legal advice.

WITH YOUR AGENT · NOTHING BY HAND

One team account, receipts from euro one



DATA § 147 AO and § 14b UStG, 8 years since 2025. Stripe docs, account set-up and KYC. Course material, the ten-receipt rule is Bastian's. Screens and chat prototyped for this course, Illustrative. Not legal advice.

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

Put in writing that the code belongs to the team

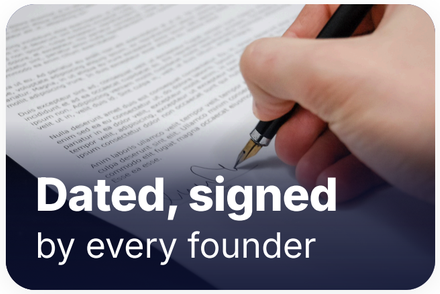
Without it, each founder keeps the rights to what they wrote

WITHOUT IT



WITH IT, DATED AND SIGNED





"Each of us grants the team the exclusive right to use all code, designs and content we create for [venture]. If one of us leaves, the rights stay."

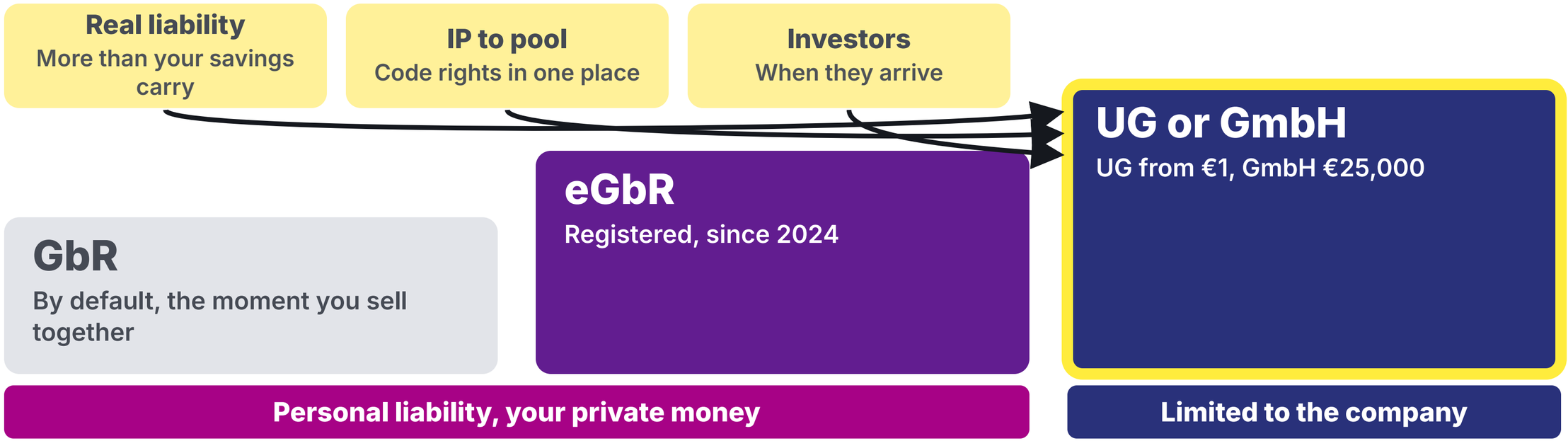
Built in a university lab or a paid job? Ask your university's IP office before you sell it.

DATA § 8, § 29, § 69a and § 69b UrhG, gesetze-im-internet.de. Schlun & Elseven (2026), founding a SaaS company. Sample wording made up, not legal advice. Photo: jarmoluk on Pixabay.

COMPANY FORM

When real risk shows up, upgrade and call a lawyer

UG from €1, GmbH with €25,000. Investors come later in the course



DATA § 5, § 5a and § 7 GmbHG, gesetze-im-internet.de. Company formation moves to Fundraising and Demo Day (M12). Not legal advice.

INPUT 4 OF 4 · PROTECT IT · THE ANSWERS

Protect it: registered, one account, the code in writing

1

Who is liable for the team's debts?

Every founder, with private money. Selling together, you are a GbR already

2

What do you set up before you sell?

A registration, one team account, receipts from euro one and the VAT note on every invoice

3

Who owns the code?

Each founder owns what they wrote, until the team puts it in writing

CHAPTER 7 OF 9

Wrap-up and check-out

Three pictures to keep, three questions to reflect on, and your week.

01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Price it: a price from value, tested~~

04 ~~Sell it: the ask inside the product~~

05 ~~Run it: checkout, webhook and deploy~~

06 ~~Protect it: keep the money legal~~

07 **Wrap-up and check-out**

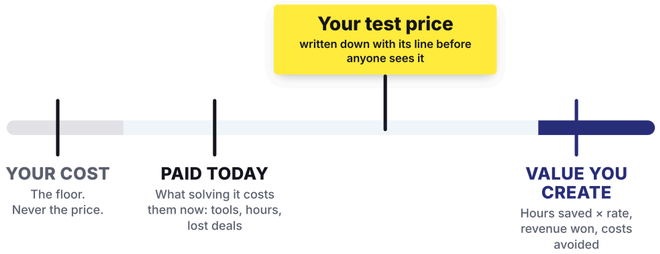
08 Workshop: Revenue Sprint

09 Case discussion

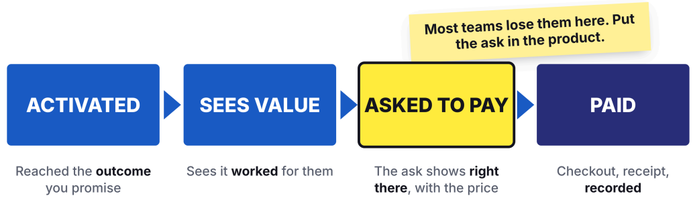
RECAP · TODAY

Price, path, plumbing. Then the paperwork

PRICE

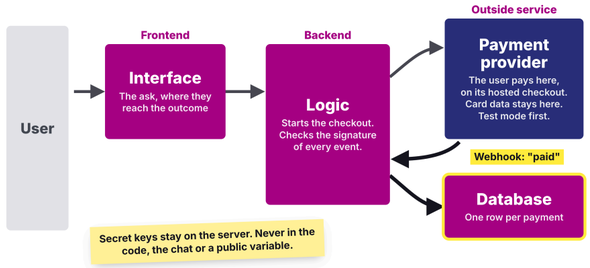


PATH



Count the steps from yes to paid. Cut every one you can.

PLUMBING



PAPERWORK

Finalist Alert GbR · Musterstraße 1 · 80333 München

Issued by the order form

Agentur Beispiel GmbH
10115 Berlin

Invoice 014
1 Dec 2026

Recruiter seat, December 2026	**€99.00**

Steuerbefreiung für Kleinunternehmer nach § 19 UStG.

Paid by transfer, reference 014, recorded

REFLECTION 1 OF 3 · THE CONTENT

What could you apply?



What could you apply?



What gave you a hard time?

REFLECTION 2 OF 3 · THE PROCESS

Man vs. machine



Where did AI actually help you?



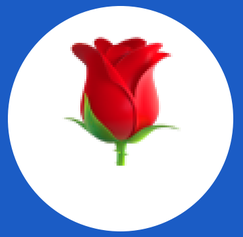
Where was your genius needed?



What are your best hacks to share?

REFLECTION 3 OF 3 · THE RESULTS

Rose, thorn, bud



What was the breakthrough today?



What was the hardest part today?



What is an idea/feature you didn't have time to finish, but want to explore later?

HOMEWORK UNTIL NEXT TIME

Run your price test, let customers pay inside your live product without a founder in the sale, and reach €1,000 cumulative revenue from outside your social graph, with the same offer bought by more than one customer.

€1,000 **full bar**

The learning floor is €500 cumulative, with at least one payment made inside your product.

Your kill line sits in the Kill Criteria Log with your midweek date, before anyone sees the price. No line? "If none of the first 10 named people from our segment we send to our price pays by [midweek date], we change the structure, not the amount, before the next 10." Under 10 sent counts as none paid.

HOMEWORK · HOW TO DO IT

Make the product take the money

1. **Send people to the product, not to you.** First users (M08)'s "not now" first, then your payers' channel and your segment's groups.
2. **Put the ask where they reach the outcome,** with the price.
3. **Cut a step to paid** every day.
4. **Let follow-ups run without you.**
5. **Hand one chore to an AI agent,** tested on 10 of your own cases first.
6. **Say no to custom work,** or price it apart.
7. **Set up the plumbing.** Register the trade, file the tax questionnaire within a month, tax number on invoices above €250, team bank account, receipts folder, code rights granted to the team in writing. Not legal advice (Legal Basics).
8. **Get a blind second opinion.** Give an AI your raw records, no names or hypothesis. Note where it disagrees.

! **Watch out.** GbR founders are liable with private money. Signing what your savings can't cover? A UG and a lawyer.

HOMEWORK · WHAT YOU COME BACK WITH

Good is tested, self-serve and repeated

	GOOD	WEAK
PRICE	€99 a seat against a line	"Survey says €20"
PAYING	11 seats, €1,089, no sales calls	Every sale a call
REPEAT	Same plan, 6 agencies	Two custom projects

Sources in this deck

Blomfield, T. (2025). The sales playbook for founders. Y Combinator Startup Library.

Camuffo, A., Cordova, A., Gambardella, A. & Spina, C. (2020). A scientific approach to entrepreneurial decision making. *Management Science*, 66(2), 564–586.

Ding, M., Grewal, R. & Liechty, J. (2005). Incentive-aligned conjoint analysis. *Journal of Marketing Research*, 42(1), 67–82.

Fitzpatrick, R. *The Mom Test*. momtestbook.com.

McKenzie, P. (2006, 2007). You can probably stand to charge more. Rates at which shareware customers request refunds. kalzumeus.com.

Murphy, L. (2012). SaaS pricing strategy: the 10x rule. Sixteen Ventures.

Nagle, T., Müller, G. & Gruyaert, E. (2023). *The Strategy and Tactics of Pricing* (7th ed.). Routledge.

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Ramanujam, M. & Tacke, G. (2016). *Monetizing Innovation*. Wiley.

Schmidt, J. & Bijmolt, T. (2020). Accurately measuring willingness to pay for consumer goods: a meta-analysis of the hypothetical bias. *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science*, 48(3), 499–518.

Van Westendorp, P. (1976). NSS-Price Sensitivity Meter (PSM). *Proceedings of the 29th ESOMAR Congress*, 139–167.

Documentation opened 19 October 2026: Stripe (webhooks, fulfilment, testing, API keys, security guide, account set-up), Vercel (Git deploys, environment variables), Next.js, Netlify, Cloudflare Pages, Anthropic (evaluations), PCI Security Standards Council, Adyen and Klarna company pages, elster.de, IHK München.

German law opened 19 October 2026 on gesetze-im-internet.de: § 19, § 14, § 14b UStG, § 33, § 34a UStDV, § 14 GewO, § 138, § 147 AO, §§ 705, 707, 707a, 721 BGB, § 5, § 5a, § 7 GmbHG, § 8, § 29, § 69a, § 69b UrhG. BMF letters of 18 March and 15 October 2025.

Schlun & Elseven Rechtsanwälte (2026). SaaS-Unternehmen gründen. se-legal.de.

Course: Glossary, GRADING_RUBRIC, framework 02 (Validation Hierarchy), framework 03 (GPK), Objection Log exemplar.

Go get paid. See you in Product management (M10)!

MODULE 09 · FROM PROTOTYPE TO PRODUCT · WORKSHOP · 90 MINUTES

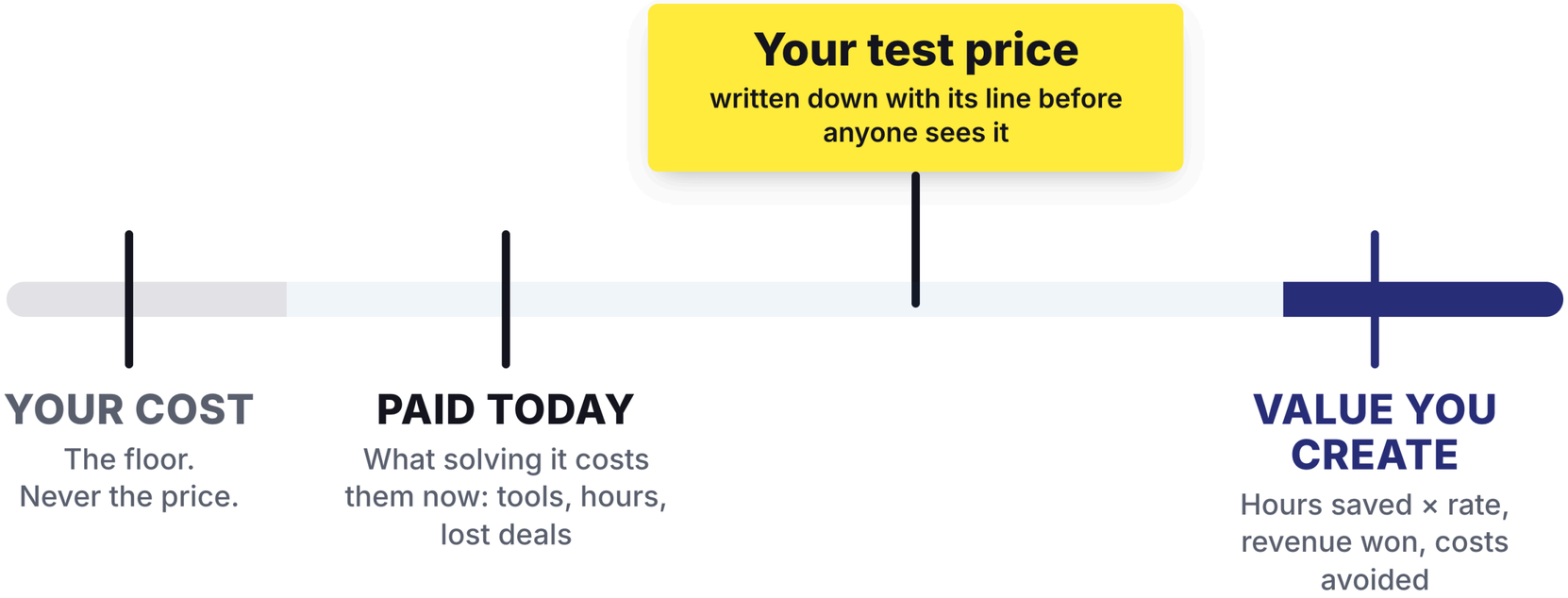
Workshop: Revenue Sprint

Price it, build the checkout, go live.

01 Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship
02 Your presentations
03 **Price it: a price from value, tested**
04 **Sell it: the ask inside the product**
05 **Run it: checkout, webhook and deploy**
06 **Protect it: keep the money legal**
07 Wrap-up and check-out
08 **Workshop: Revenue Sprint**
09 Case discussion

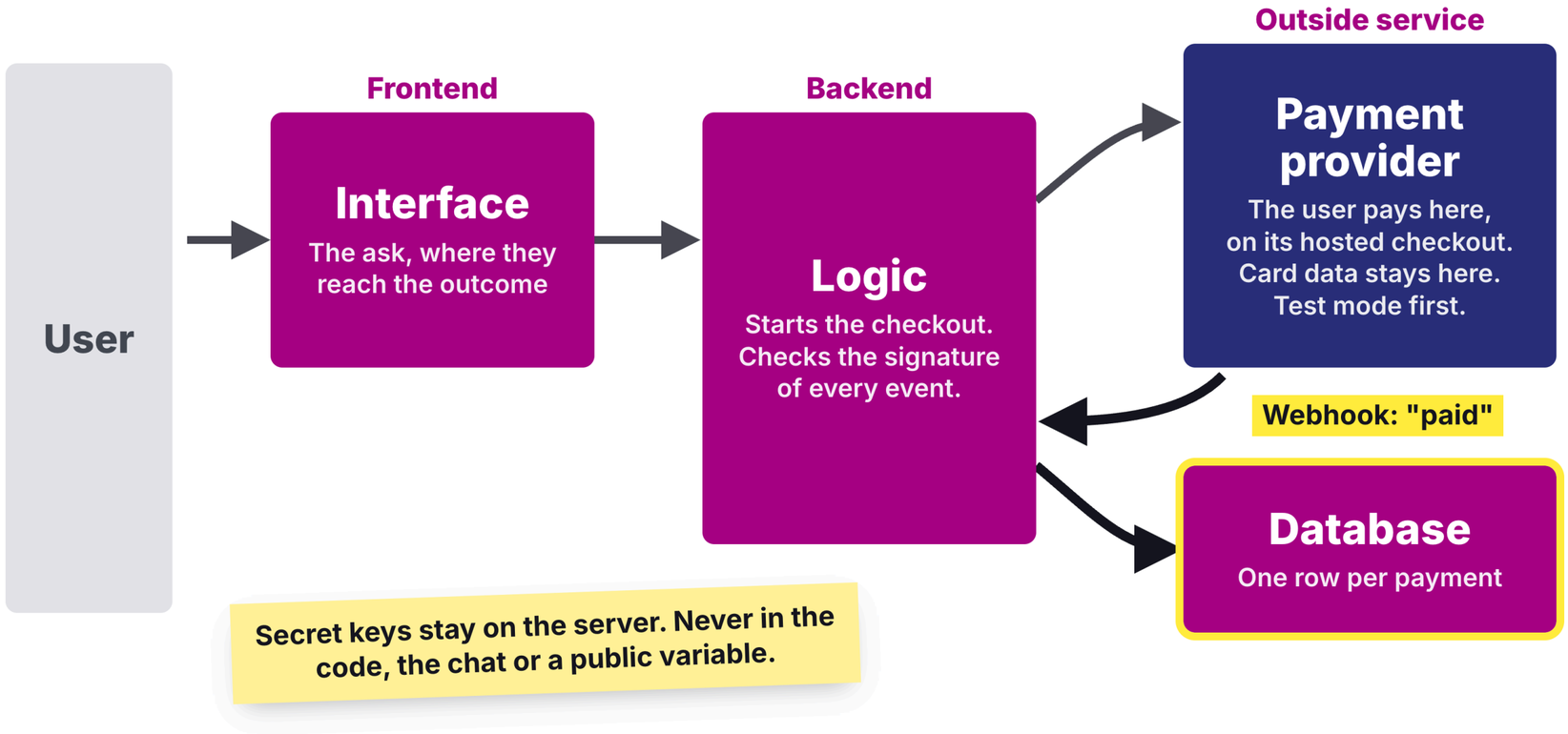
WORKSHOP · THE FIGURE FOR STEP 1

Price the outcome, not your effort



WORKSHOP · THE FIGURE FOR STEP 2

Every payment writes its own row



HOMEWORK UNTIL NEXT TIME

Run your price test, let customers pay inside your live product without a founder in the sale, and reach €1,000 cumulative revenue from outside your social graph, with the same offer bought by more than one customer.

€1,000 full bar

The learning floor is €500 cumulative, with at least one payment made inside your product.

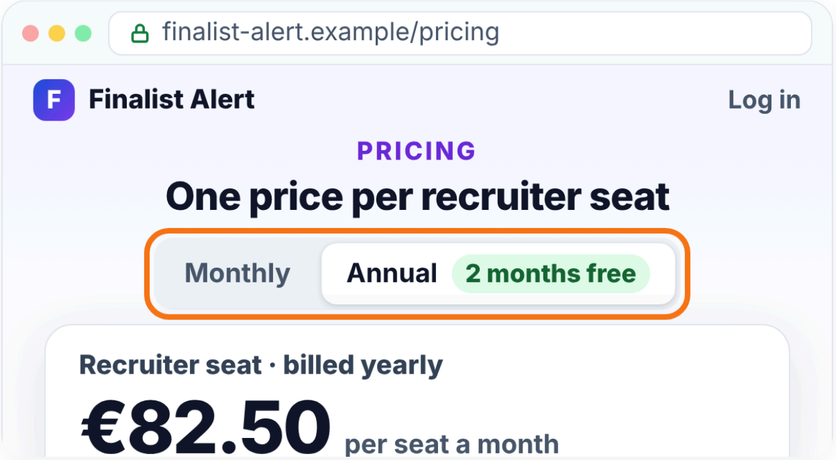
Your kill line sits in the Kill Criteria Log with your midweek date, before anyone sees the price. No line? "If none of the first 10 named people from our segment we send to our price pays by [midweek date], we change the structure, not the amount, before the next 10." Under 10 sent counts as none paid.

WORKSHOP · STEP 1 OF 3

Price it

One price to test.

- [ ] Name the unit that grows with their value
- [ ] Price from value and today's spend, cost is the floor
- [ ] Pick the price to test, payments test it
- [ ] Log your line with your midweek date first



20:00

OUTPUT

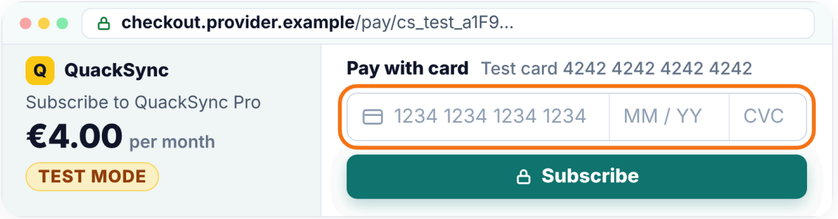
A unit, a test price, a dated line.

WORKSHOP · STEP 2 OF 3

Build the checkout

A test payment lands in your product's records.

- [ ] Count the steps from yes to paid, cut some
- [ ] Brief your coding agent, small steps
- [ ] Hosted checkout, signed webhook, each payment once
- [ ] Secret keys on the server, never public
- [ ] Deploy from your repository, pay again in test mode



50:00

OUTPUT

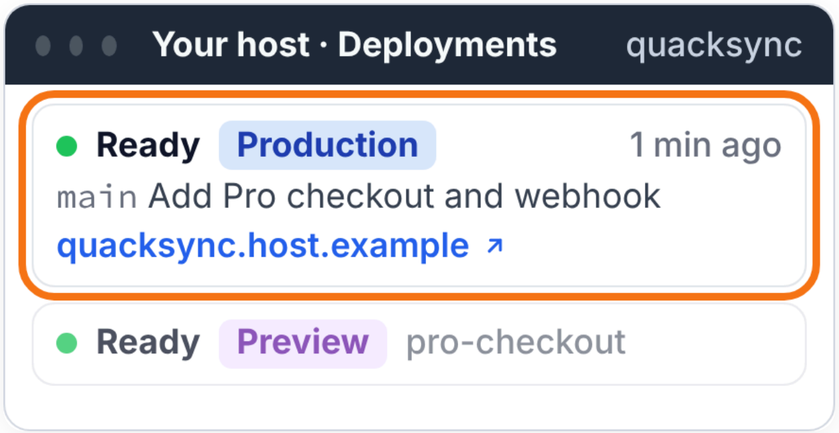
A test payment recorded in your deployed product.

WORKSHOP · STEP 3 OF 3

Go live, then commit

Real people see your price today.

- [ ] Plumbing: team account, numbered invoices, § 19 line
- [ ] Switch to live, or invoice meanwhile
- [ ] Send First users (M08)'s "not now" to the product
- [ ] Commit to the bar, each founder's count, midweek euros



20:00

OUTPUT

A live ask, first people sent, targets.

ARRIVED EMPTY-HANDED?

Price your concierge offer and charge for it



No price? Price your concierge offer, build a page that charges for it.
No contacts? Send it to your interviewees and your segment's groups.
No repository or account? Builder payments and a sandbox.

Go get paid. See you in Product management (M10)!

MODULE 09 · FROM PROTOTYPE TO PRODUCT · CASE DISCUSSION · ABOUT 90 MINUTES

Case discussion: tado°

Stand with Christian Deilmann in Munich in mid-July 2013 and decide how a household pays for a smart heating box.

01 Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

02 Your presentations

03 **Price it: a price from value, tested**

04 **Sell it: the ask inside the product**

05 **Run it: checkout, webhook and deploy**

06 **Protect it: keep the money legal**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: Revenue Sprint

09 **Case discussion**

CASE · tado° GmbH · MUNICH, MID-JULY 2013 · VOTE 1 OF 2

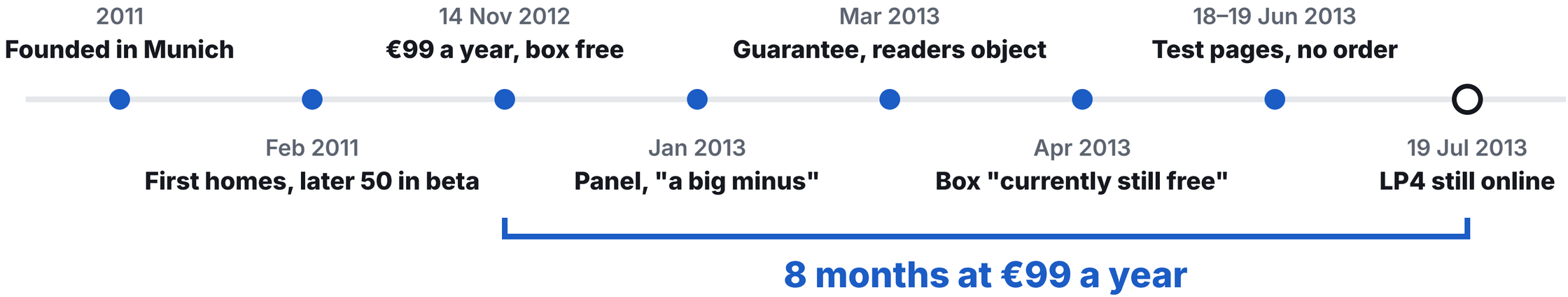
How should tado° ask a household to pay?

OPTION 1	OPTION 2	OPTION 3	OPTION 4	OPTION 5
Subscription, the box free	**Subscription at €149 + €99 a year**	**Flex, €149 + a monthly fee**	**Life, €299 once**	**A price tied to the saving**
Hands	Hands	Hands	Hands	Hands

DATA Prototype to product (M09) case: tado°, "Box, Service or Saving?". The options as the case's closing states them, offers tado° showed and advice it received. Logos are trademarks of their owners.

CASE · WHAT HAPPENED UNTIL MID-JULY 2013

Eight months at €99 a year, the box free only for now



CASE · THE BOARD PLAN

Judge every option on the same four rows

Votes · first count · second count

	1 · Box free	2 · €149 + €99 a year	3 · Flex	4 · Life	5 · Tied to the saving
Pays for: box, service or saving?					
For					
Against					
The line before the test					

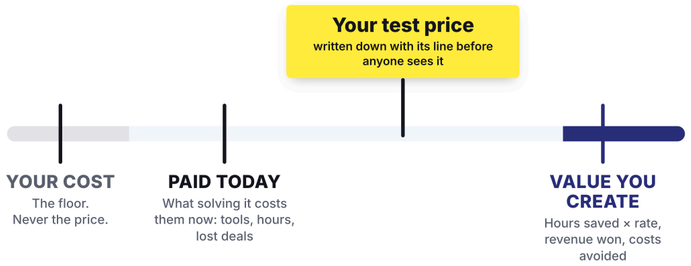
Steps from yes to paid

DATA Prototype to product (M09) case: tado°, the five options of the case's closing.

CASE · BOX, SERVICE OR SAVING · 30 MINUTES

What does a tado° customer pay for?

Place the case's numbers on the scale



Your cost

Not disclosed. The box was priced at €149

C35

Paid today

€715 to €890 a year to heat 70 m². RWE €189 or €319, then €14.95 a year

C11 · C31

Test prices

€99 a year. Flex €149 + €2.99 or €4.99. Life €299

C16 · C36

Value

About €257 to €285 a year saved, tado°'s claim

C10

CASE · EXHIBIT 4 · THE HY! PANEL, JANUARY 2013

Three panelists on how to sell and how to charge

Deilmann answered the point on the display. No answer of his on pricing is recorded

PANELIST 1

"might actually be better if you went straight to the utilities"

PANELIST 2

"I would price it based on how much it lowers the use of energy and somehow figure a cost sharing with the user."

PANELIST 3

"a big minus for consumers down the road", against a "200 euro box right from the get-go that they own forever"

PANELIST 1, SECOND QUOTE

"if you price at $99, you also have to tell people that you're saving $1,000 a year or something of that sort"

DATA Video of the hy! pitch and the panel, uploaded 24 January 2013, transcribed by the case writer, case Exhibit 4. Panelists not named.

CASE · EXHIBIT 2 · 20 MINUTES

Which result, by which date, would have chosen each?

The pages took e-mail addresses and package choices. No order, no published result

PAGE AND OFFER, AS SHOWN	Cost to the household, € (first year, three years)	
LP4 · Flex €149 + €2.99 a month	First year	€184.88
	Three years	€256.64
LP5 · Flex €149 + €4.99 a month	First year	€208.88
	Three years	€328.64
LP4, LP5 · Life €299 once, lifetime use	First year	€299.00
	Three years	€299.00
LP6 · yearly €99 a year, box included	First year	€99.00
	Three years	€297.00
Shop · standard terms €149 box + €99 a year	First year	€248.00
	Three years	€446.00

DATA Landing pages LP4 to LP6 and FAQ of tado° as captured by the Internet Archive, costs calculated by the case writer, case Exhibit 2. Bars to scale.



CASE · STEPS FROM YES TO PAID · 10 MINUTES

Which offer lets the unsure pay on the page?

Without asking for the free call-back

FROM YES TO PAID AT TADO°, JUNE 2013, AS THE CASE DOCUMENTS IT

Visit	Check your heating, step 1 of 4	Or call for "availability and ordering"	Pay a year upfront	Box arrives, install it yourself

Hurdle

A year paid upfront, €99

C06

Hurdle

A box at €149 or €299

C16 · C36

Hurdle

A first term of one year in the FAQ

C40

On offer

Money back in year one on returning the box

C14

DATA Prototype to product (M09) case: tado°, "A Box and an App" and "What Customers and Advisers Said" (C44, C47, C06, C24).

CASE · VOTE 2 OF 2

Same question. Who moved, and why?

OPTION 1	OPTION 2	OPTION 3	OPTION 4	OPTION 5
Subscription, the box free	**Subscription at €149 + €99 a year**	**Flex, €149 + a monthly fee**	**Life, €299 once**	**A price tied to the saving**
Hands	Hands	Hands	Hands	Hands

DATA Prototype to product (M09) case: tado°, "Box, Service or Saving?". The options as the case's closing states them, offers tado° showed and advice it received.

See you next time!